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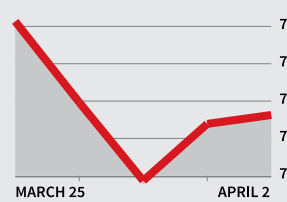


Source
1. Google commissioned Kantar Sports Fan Research 2024, Deloitte analysis.
2. In an MMM meta-analysis we commissioned with Nielsen, on average, YouTube effectiveness was 24.11 times greater than Linear TV effectiveness across Total CPG MMMs that measured YouTube, Other Digital, and Linear TV from Jan'20- Sep'23 in India. According to a meta analysis of CPG MMM Studies by Analytic Edge in India, YouTube ROI was 3.0x of OTT Platforms ROI (2021-2024)

the hindu businessline

SENSEX 73319.55 (+185.23)

IN FOCUS



	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	22713.10	+33.70
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	20.15	+0.05
US Dollar (in ₹)	93.10	-1.73
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	146021.00	-4228
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	227813.00	-12023

REALITY CHECK.

Salesforce CEO Arundhati Bhattacharya

highlights AI adoption challenges for Indian firms amid global uncertainty **p12**



POLLSCAPE.

Amid widespread discontent, BJP and TMC ready for a stiff electoral battle p7

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All Products

Rupee leaps 173 paise on RBI intervention

BIGGEST DAY GAIN IN A DECADE. Central bank tightens forex derivative norms, caps net open position limits

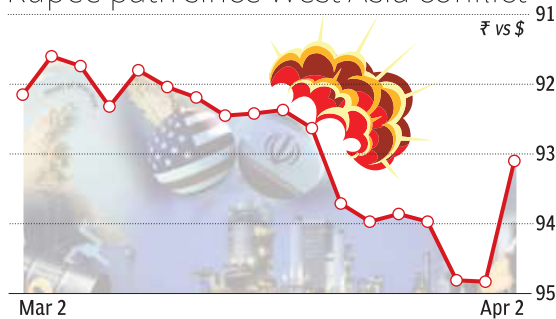
K Ram Kumar
Mumbai

The rupee started the new financial year (FY27) with a bang thanks to the RBI's two recent measures — capping the net open position limits and tightening forex derivative rules — to curb speculative pressure on the domestic currency.

The central bank's measures had the desired effect, with the rupee, which depreciated 9.8 per cent in FY26 against 2.5 per cent in FY25, notching up on Thursday the biggest single-day gain in more than a decade.

It gained 173 paise to close at 93.10 per US dollar, making a smart recovery from the previous (March 30) close of 94.83, which was a record low. The forex market remained closed on the following two days — March 31

Rupee path since West Asia conflict



(Mahavir Jayanti) and April 1 (annual closing of accounts for banks).

Opening 130 paise stronger at 93.53 against the previous close, the rupee tested an intra-day high/low of 92.82/93.6575.

EQUITIES RECOVER

Buoyed by the rupee and short-covering, equities wiped out the day's losses to end higher, with the Nifty50

swinging up over 500 points from its day's low to close up 0.2 per cent, and Sensex up 0.3 per cent.

The rupee has been under pressure post the West Asia war leading to a spike in global energy prices and disrupting supply chains, triggering demand for safe-haven dollar assets (resulting in FPIs' exit from Indian equities) and the strengthening of the greenback.

A Barclays report said the RBI delivered a double whammy to speculators, effectively bifurcating the rupee market. The rupee could rally further in the near term though there could eventually be some offshore convergence, it said.

Amit Pabari, MD, CR Forex Advisor, said that the rupee is going through a phase of tighter regulatory control, with the RBI stepping in to calm volatility and reduce excessive market positioning.

RBI CLAMPDOWN

In its March 27 circular, the RBI capped the Net Open Position in INR (NOP-INR) for banks at \$100 million.

"Simply put, this measure forces banks to cut large dollar bets, leading to an unwinding of positions. As these trades get reversed, dollars come back into the

market, which helps ease immediate pressure on the rupee and brings some near-term stability," Pabari said.

He underscored that the RBI went a step further and tightened rules in the derivatives market to address the root cause of volatility. So, banks can no longer offer non-deliverable forwards to clients, and participants are restricted from maintaining offsetting offshore positions. Rebooking of cancelled contracts is also no longer allowed.

"In simple terms, the RBI is closing the gap between offshore and onshore markets and reducing arbitrage opportunities. This means that the market will now be driven more by real hedging needs rather than speculative trades, making price movements more controlled and transparent," Pabari said.

Sundaram Clayton corrects governance lapse in Company Secretary appointment

Sindhu Hariharan
Chennai

Sundaram Clayton has started the process of correcting a corporate governance lapse with respect to the appointment and reporting structure of its Company Secretary, PD Dev Kishan, which was basically a legacy issue.

businessline learns that Dev Kishan, who resigned on March 27 (Friday) and was brought back on March 30 (Monday), has now been made a full-time employee of Sundaram Clayton.

Further, once a junior-level employee, his grade has now been brought appropriate to his stature as a Key Managerial Personnel. While he was earlier appointed by TVS Holding and reporting to its CFO, steps are now being taken to also bring in his reporting structure within

Sundaram Clayton, said sources in the know.

FAMILY ARRANGEMENT

As for the return of the patriarch Venu Srinivasan as Executive Chairman of the company, sources note that the family arrangement in 2022 had clearly determined that governance and legal compliance across the group companies always rested with Srinivasan while his children would take care of the operational aspects of respective companies. He was already the Chairman Emeritus and Managing Director at the firm, they add.

Srinivasan endeavoured to rectify the terms of appointment of Dev Kishan and called for a second board meeting on Monday to bring him back, another source said. It was called at a short notice so as to ensure that it got done before the new Sec-

retary's appointment kicks in on April 6, they added. However, some questions still remain.

Sundaram Clayton's board had earlier approved Dev Kishan's secondment from TVS Holdings and was also paying his salary since the demerger of the Group, one of the persons in the know said. The suddenness of the move of seeking his resignation raises questions, they add.

Corporate governance experts note the tendency of large groups to have a shared pool of resources leading to complications. "Large groups tend to have pooled resources even when they have multiple listed companies. This defeats the purpose of a dedicated compliance officer for each listed company," said Shriram Subramanian, Founder and MD, InGovern Research Services.

SEBI proposes bringing back open-market share buybacks through stock exchanges

Akshata Gorde
Mumbai

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) proposes to re-open share buybacks through stock exchanges, nearly a year after closing the route, citing a more neutral tax framework and industry demand for greater flexibility.

The regulator said the mechanism could be reinstated as an additional method under existing buyback regulations, alongside the tender offer and book-building routes.

SEBI has proposed that buybacks via stock exchanges be conducted via a separate window, with existing safeguards on price, volume and disclosures continuing to apply.

The proposal is open for public comments till April 23.

MORE FLEXIBILITY

- SEBI proposes restoring stock-exchange buybacks as an additional route
- Route was scrapped in April 2025 over unequal participation and tax distortions
- The Finance Act, 2026, shifts tax burden on to shareholders (capital gains), narrowing earlier inequity



The stock exchange route was phased out and eventually discontinued from April 1, 2025, on concerns over equitable treatment of shareholders and tax distortions that favoured select participants.

Under the earlier system, buyback orders could be matched with a handful of shareholders, leaving others unable to participate despite their willingness.

TAX ASPECT

"The differential tax advantage that existed earlier ...

would not exist any longer," SEBI said in a draft paper issued on Thursday, adding that buyback proceeds will now be taxed as capital gains in the hands of shareholders, aligning them with normal market transactions.

The mechanism operates within an "order-driven market", where execution is determined by price-time matching, offering "equal opportunity" under uniform conditions, SEBI said.

Open market buybacks are widely used globally, aiding continuous price discovery

and enhancing liquidity. Industry bodies, including FICCI and AIBI, have backed the move, arguing that it allows companies to gradually absorb selling pressure and deploy surplus cash efficiently.

"Promoters are proposed to be excluded from selling in the stock exchange buyback window, and the Finance Act, 2026, imposes additional tax and surcharge on promoter shareholders to reduce arbitrage. So, direct preferential monetisation through this route appears constrained," said Rohit Jain, Managing Partner at Singhania & Co.

STRUCTURAL CONCERNS

However, "...open market buybacks... revive concerns around unequal participation and opaque price discovery," said Raheel Patel, Partner at Gandhi Law Associates.

Penalty clause in GE Aerospace-HAL deal to kick in for missed Tejas engine supplies

Dalip Singh
New Delhi

With GE Aerospace missing multiple deadlines for the supply of F404-IN20 engines to power Tejas LCA Mk1A, the penalty clause outlined in the August 2021 contract Hindustan Aeronautics Ltd (HAL) signed with the American giant will be automatically invoked. Of the overall 99 engines contracted for \$716 million, GE has supplied 5 engines and the sixth is *en route* to India. Deliveries were to start in 2023, but got delayed for about two years and the first engine was supplied only in March 2025.

A subsequent contract was also inked with GE on November 7, 2025, for approximately \$1 billion, to



BEHIND SCHEDULE. GE Aerospace has promised to supply 20 F404-IN20 engines by the year-end

support 97 more LCA Mk1A jets, and the deliveries are supposed to take place from 2027 and end in 2032.

25 ENGINES BY YEAR-END

As per the 'pessimistic assessment,' GE promised to supply 20 of the 99 F404-IN20 engines towards December as they claim to have overcome global supply chain issues, top HAL sources said. The best case scenario, however, is for the

shipment of 25 engines by the year-end, they added.

HAL sources said that a percentage of the value of an engine will get deducted for liquidated damages and penalties (LDA), that is, a predetermined sum stipulated in the contract that one party agrees to pay the other in the event of breach of a specific clause.

Owing to the cascading effect of delayed supply of engines, the induction of the

LCA Mk1A into the Indian Air Force has been affected.

HAL sources stated that it, too, will have to pay LDA to the IAF for the delay in delivering the indigenous aircraft.

ONE SQUADRON BY DEC

HAL Chairman and Managing Director DK Sunil said, "We will be ready to deliver 20 LCA Mk1A jets, which is one full squadron to the IAF by December after getting the engines, and that six of them could be supplied soon as the final tests of radar integration, avionics have been done and advanced short-range air-to-air missile twin firing needs to be sorted out". Once that is done, a review of the progress made on making the fighters ready for induction will take place in May, the CMD said.

A new era for Garden Vareli begins

We are proud to announce the launch of Garden Vareli's state-of-the-art D2C (Direct-to-Consumer) platform. This digital evolution represents a significant milestone in our journey to bring world-class fashion directly to the doorsteps of the modern, conscious woman.

More than just a platform, this initiative marks a strategic pivot for **The Chatterjee Group (TCG)**, as it expands its storied expertise in Petrochemicals, Technology, and Life Sciences into the vibrant world of consumer-centric businesses.

And at the heart of it all, is a woman who now experiences Garden Vareli, on her terms.

Marking this milestone, the platform will be launched in Mumbai, today, on April 3, 2026 by **Dr. Purnendu Chatterjee, Founder & Chairman, The Chatterjee Group (TCG).**

Visit our website – gardenvareli.com

QUICKLY.

Fire at Sundaram Brake Linings plant in TN



Chennai: A fire broke out at Sundaram Brake Linings Ltd's Plant II in Kariapatti, Virudhunagar district, Tamil Nadu, around 5.25 am on Thursday, temporarily impacting operations. The company said the blaze was brought under control promptly, and reported no casualties or injuries. However, operations in the affected section have been temporarily shut down. Preliminary estimates place the damage at about ₹2.66 crore. The firm added that the impacted assets are adequately insured and the insurer has been notified, with a survey expected to be conducted soon. **OUR BUREAU**

Recover non-performance penalty from Airtel: CAG



New Delhi: Digital Bharat Nidhi (DBN), a rural telecom development fund under the Department of Telecom, should recover damages and non-performance penalty of ₹8.49 crore from Bharti Airtel, pending for four years, a CAG report said. The report tabled in Parliament on Thursday observed DBN entered a deal with Airtel in 2017 to provide mobile coverage in Assam and Sikkim, with all sites to be commissioned by June 2019, but there are several yet to be set up. **PTI**

CBIC waives full customs duty on critical petrochemical products

TIMELY MEASURE. Move to insulate manufacturers from supply disruptions, price volatility amid Iran conflict

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Finance Ministry on Thursday announced complete customs duty waiver on 40 petrochemical products, effective through June 30, in a strategic move to insulate domestic manufacturers from supply chain disruptions and price volatility triggered by the ongoing West Asia conflict.

These products are essential raw materials across various industrial sectors, and the intervention aims to stabilise production costs amid regional instability. Official estimates show the tax break is expected to result in a revenue loss of approximately ₹1,800 crore to the national exchequer over the three-month period.

SECTOR-WISE

“The exemption is expected to benefit a wide range of sectors dependent on petrochemical feedstock and intermediates, including plastics, packaging, textiles, pharmaceuticals, chemicals, automotive components and other manufacturing segments. This will also provide relief to consumers of final products,” the Ministry said.

It clarified the decision was prompted by the escalating West Asia conflict and resulting turbulence in global supply chains. By removing these trade barriers, the government aims to shield the domestic market from external shocks. “This measure has been taken as a temporary and targeted relief in order to ensure continued availability of critical petrochemical inputs for domestic industry, reduce cost pressures on downstream



THE IMPACT. Official estimates show that the tax break is expected to result in a revenue loss of approximately ₹1,800 crore to the national exchequer

sectors, and safeguard supply stability in the country,” it added.

However, domestic petrochemical majors such as Reliance Industries, Indian Oil Corporation, GAIL (India) and Haldia Petrochemicals manufacture several products included in the duty waiver list. For instance, Reliance produces key polymers such as polypropylene, polyethylene, PVC and PET chips, alongside intermediates such as monoethylene glycol (MEG) and purified terephthalic acid (PTA), all of which feature in the list. Indian Oil manufactures polypropylene and linear alkylbenzene (LAB) at its integrated petrochemical complexes, while GAIL produces polyethylene and polypropylene at its Pata petrochemical plant. Haldia Petrochemicals, another major domestic player, manufactures polypropylene and polyethylene, widely used in

packaging, consumer goods and automotive components. Industry executives noted many of these companies have been lobbying for imposition of anti-dumping duties against low-cost imports, particularly from China, in segments such as PVC, PTA, polystyrene and styrene, citing margin pressure and rising inventory levels. Last month, the DGTR initiated a counter-vailing duty (anti-subsidy) investigation into PVC resin imports from China. This followed a joint application by major domestic players including Chemplast Cudalore Vinyls, DCM Shriram, and DCW Ltd, who alleged that Chinese subsidies were allowing exporters to undercut domestic prices. The waiver could add to the pressure on these industries.

However, Amitt Nennwani, Managing Director, Shivtek Specchemi Industries, hailed the waiver as “timely and

List of goods on which the customs duty has been exempted

- Anhydrous ammonia
- Toluene
- Styrene
- Dichloromethane (methylene chloride)
- Vinyl chloride monomer
- Methanol (methyl alcohol)
- Isopropyl alcohol
- Monoethylene Glycol (MEG)
- Phenol
- Acetic acid
- Vinyl acetate monomer
- Purified terephthalic acid (PTA)
- Ethylenediamine
- Di ethanolamine and mono ethanolamine
- Toluene di-isocyanate
- Ammonium nitrate
- Linear alkylbenzenes
- Polymers of ethylene (including ethylene-vinyl acetate)
- Polypropylene
- Polystyrene
- Styrene-acrylonitrile (SAN)
- Acrylonitrile-butadiene-styrene (ABS)
- Polyvinyl chloride (PVC)
- Polytetrafluoroethylene
- Polyvinyl acetate
- Polyvinyl alcohol
- Poly (methyl methacrylate)
- Polyoxymethylene (POM- acetal)
- Polyols
- Polyether ether ketone (PEEK)
- Epoxy resins
- Polycarbonates
- Alkyd resins
- Poly ethylene terephthalate (PET) chips
- Unsaturated polyester resins
- Poly butylene terephthalate
- Formaldehyde, urea formaldehyde, melamine formaldehyde, phenol formaldehyde
- Polyurethanes
- Polyphenylene sulphide (PPS)
- Poly butadiene, styrene butadiene

pragmatic intervention”. He noted that by neutralising cost pressures from West Asian supply shocks, the move preserves domestic manufacturing momentum through the coming quarter. For the specialty chemicals sector, however, the impact goes beyond mere fiscal savings.

This is third such measure from CBIC. Last week it slashed excise duty on petrol and diesel by ₹10 a litre as it

looked to shield consumers from the impact of rising global crude prices, and also imposed an export duty of ₹21.50 per litre on diesel and ₹29.50 per litre on aviation turbine fuel (ATF). Excise duty on petrol has been slashed to ₹3 a litre, while on diesel it is zero currently. Then on Tuesday, it notified Budget announcement to allow SEZ to sell various goods in domestic market after fulfilling certain conditions.

FY26 defence exports hit all-time high ₹38,424 cr

Our Bureau
New Delhi



The record high figure indicates an increase by around three times in the last five years

Defence exports touched an all-time high of ₹38,424 crore in the FY26, marking a massive rise of ₹14,802 crore which is 62.66 per cent over the previous fiscal year's figure of ₹23,622 crore, the Ministry of Defence said in a statement on Thursday.

Defence public sector undertakings (DPSUs) and the private sector contributed 54.84 per cent and 45.16 per cent respectively.

MARCHING AHEAD

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh lauded this exemplary performance of the Department of Defence Production, Indian defence exporters and all other stakeholders, and asserted that India is marching ahead towards becoming a global manufacturing hub for defence equipment.

In a post on X, Singh stated that “under the inspiring leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, India is scripting an impressive defence exports success story.”

This big jump of ₹14,802 crore in defence exports reflects the growing global trust in India's indigenous capabilities and advanced manufacturing strength, he added.

DPSUs' exports surged by 151 per cent compared to the previous year, with private firms showcasing their robust presence by recording an increase of 14 per cent.

According to the Ministry, in terms of value of contribution, the private sector accounted defence exports worth ₹17,353 crore, while DPSUs contributed ₹21,071 crore.

Their respective figures in the previous financial year stood at ₹15,233 crore and ₹8,389 crore.

This record high figure indicates an increase by

around three times in the last five years. This sharp rise highlights the increasing global acceptance of Indian-made defence products and the sector's growing integration into the international supply chains, the MoD added.

GLOBAL PARTNER

Apart from being a successful global partner for systems/sub-systems, India is exporting defence equipment such as Dornier aircrafts, BrahMos supersonic cruise missiles, Akash air defence systems, Pinaka rockets, lightweight torpedoes, fast interceptor boats, armoured vehicles, and small arms/ammunition to more than 80 countries as of FY26.

The number of exporters underwent a surge to 145 from 128, a 13.3 per cent rise from the previous fiscal.

The government's continuous endeavours towards ease of doing business and facilitation of defence exporters have paved the way for a performance oriented and globally competitive defence industry.

To support defence exporters in this growth trajectory, the Department of Defence Production has streamlined defence export regulatory processes with a revamped online portal and simplified standard operating procedure for authorisations.

+ BMW surges, Audi slumps as luxury EV market splits

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Luxury passenger EV market is splitting sharply in FY26, with BMW scaling to record highs even as Audi's volumes have collapsed, exposing a widening gap in how automakers are executing electric strategies, industry observers said.

Data from the Vahan portal show BMW India more than doubled EV sales to 3,537 units in FY26, up from 1,580 units a year ago, lifting market share to 65 per cent from 47 per cent.

In contrast, Audi's volumes fell sharply to just 17 units from 131 in FY25, one of the steepest declines.

The contrast, in many ways, captures the rise of BMW and the fall of Audi in India's luxury EV market, analysts said.

The gap with other com-



BMW India more than doubled its EV sales to 3,537 units in FY26

petitors has also widened. Mercedes-Benz India, the segment's traditional leader in overall luxury vehicles, saw its EV sales decline 10 per cent on-year to 1,047 units, with its market share dropping to 19 per cent from 34 per cent.

The decline reflects supply constraints, pricing pressures, and a shift in buyer preference at the top end, where diesel-powered models continue to dominate, limiting the addressable

Sales trend		
Brand	FY25	FY26
BMW	1,580	3,537
Mercedes	1,157	1,047
Volvo	403	382
Tesla	0	342
Porsche	58	59
Audi	131	17
Rolls-Royce	0	15
JLR	0	5

market for high-end EVs.

In contrast, BMW has driven volumes through competitively priced entry-level offerings such as the iX1, which accounts for a significant share of its sales.

Analysts said BMW's ability to position EVs closer to internal combustion models has reduced the friction for first-time luxury EV buyers.

BMW Group India President Hardeep Singh Brar said the company's record performance was driven by

strong demand for its expanding EV portfolio.

“This success has been made possible by BMW's advanced technology, higher driving range, and a growing charging ecosystem. Our ‘power of choice’ strategy, offering petrol, diesel, and electric powertrains on shared platforms, along with local assembly and competitive pricing, has helped accelerate adoption,” he said.

CHAUFFEUR-DRIVEN

At the top end, models such as the i7 are gaining traction among chauffeur-driven buyers, reflecting evolving usage patterns, analysts said.

The divergence is not just about demand, but execution. BMW has focused on localisation, pricing, and portfolio breadth, while competitors balance premium positioning with the need to build EV scale.

FMCG firms ‘likely to hike prices by 3-4% in June quarter due to raw material costs’

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

FMCG companies are likely to hike prices by 3-4 per cent in the June quarter to mitigate raw material cost pressures, according to a report by Nuvama Institutional Equities.

It added that in categories such as paints, edible oils, soaps and detergents, the hikes could be even higher.

“In our view, companies typically maintain 30-45

days of raw material and finished goods inventory. Hence, we forecast price hikes are likely to be in Q1 FY27. Higher crude oil prices and rupee depreciation have raised input cost pressures, mainly through higher packaging costs, which comprise about 20 per cent of costs. We forecast at least 3-4 per cent price hikes in Q1 FY27 if current raw material inflation persists. Paints, edible oil, soaps and detergents could see even higher hikes,” Abneesh Roy, Executive Director & Head of Research Committee, Nuvama Institutional Equities, said.

He added that to manage rising input costs, FMCG companies were recalibrating pricing strategies and packaging structures through grammage reduction in smaller packs to maintain affordability, and price hikes in larger packs, where consumer sensitivity is lower.



The shortage of commercial LPG has also impacted FMCG companies

GEOPOLITICAL CRISIS

The report pointed out that edible oil companies have already raised prices by ₹4-5 per litre in recent weeks due to the impact of the ongoing geopolitical crisis.

It also pointed out that inflation in palm oil is likely to increase cost pressures for soap manufacturers where palm oil derivatives are a key raw material.

Food companies may also go for a price hike in the June quarter due to palm oil inflation.

“India remains heavily dependent on imports for edible oils, primarily crude palm oil, crude soybean oil and crude sunflower oil, which together account for 89-90 per cent of India's total vegetable oil imports,” the report added.

For paint companies, nearly 40 per cent of raw materials are linked to crude derivatives and the recent increase in crude oil prices has started translating into higher input costs.

Most companies have already taken one round of price hikes and are expected to undertake a second round in June quarter depending on crude prices, the report added.

Meanwhile, the shortage of commercial LPG has also impacted FMCG firms.

Marico posts low 20% revenue growth in Q4

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Marico Ltd on Thursday said consolidated revenue rose in the low twenties on-year in Q4 FY26, underpinned by strong volume growth and sustained momentum in its international business, and added it was confident of delivering healthy volume-led revenue growth in FY27.

“This performance was underpinned by top-quartile volume growth, a robust recovery in VAHO (value-added hair oils) and strong momentum in the international business,” the company said in its quarterly update.

Among its key raw materials, copra prices corrected 35 per cent from its peak while vegetable oils and crude-sensitive materials saw an upward bias, and the company said it would take selective pricing actions to offset the impact, while maintaining brand investments. “We expect double-



WIDENING SCOPE. Industry observers said Marico's growth reflects a broadening of its portfolio beyond core oils

digit operating profit growth in this quarter, with a sequential improvement in growth.”

The India business posted high single-digit underlying volume growth, with a sequential improvement during the quarter, even as overall consumption trends remained gradual.

GROWTH DRIVER

A key growth driver was the VAHO segment, which recorded growth in the twen-



This has been a very positive year for both the tractor market and farmers across the country

LAKSHMI VENU
Vice-Chairman, TAFE



sion initiatives to support future growth, the release stated.

GST BOOST

“This has been a very positive year for both the tractor market and for farmers across the country. In addition to favourable monsoons, the government's move to reduce GST has provided significant relief to the farming sector,” Lakshmi Venu, Vice-Chairman, TAFE,

said in the statement. “We are now seeing a very encouraging trend in the penetration of mechanisation in rural areas. This year marks a meaningful shift in the access to mechanisation for small farmers with many first time users entering the mechanisation ecosystem. This will go a long way in improving farm productivity and strengthening farmer incomes across the country,” she added.

India business posted high single-digit underlying volume growth, with a sequential improvement, even as overall consumption trends remained gradual

foods emerging as key engines. Analysts added that the company's focus on mid and premium segments, product innovation, and direct distribution expansion through Project SETU are supporting sustained growth in these segments.

The international business maintained high-teen constant currency growth, although the Gulf region was impacted by geopolitical headwinds towards the end of the quarter.

QUICKLY.

Maldives seeks fuel from India amid Iran war

New Delhi: The Maldives is seeking fuel supplies from India, which is continuing to ship out fuel to neighbouring countries, a spokesperson for the Ministry of External Affairs said on Thursday. India, the world's fourth biggest refiner, is supplying fuel to Bangladesh, Nepal, Bhutan and Sri Lanka under commercial engagements, said Randhir Jaiswal. Maldives typically sources most of its fuel from Oman, according to World Bank data. REUTERS

NTPC sees highest-ever capacity addition in FY26

New Delhi: NTPC on Thursday said it generated 432.2 billion units of electricity and achieved highest every capacity addition of 9,619 MW in fiscal year 2025-26. NTPC added 5,488 MW of renewable capacity in FY26 across solar, wind and Pumped Storage Projects, a company statement said. In FY26, NTPC achieved coal production of 48.65 million tonnes (mt), registering a steady 6.22 per cent year-on-year growth. It also recorded a strong growth in power trading, with 46.52 billion units traded in FY26, up 13 per cent year-on-year. PTI

Indirect tax collection exceeds RE in FY26, say govt officials

CAUTIOUS OUTLOOK. Target for the current fiscal (FY27) remains under review

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Indirect tax collections for FY26 have surpassed the revised estimates (RE), government officials confirmed on Thursday. While the previous fiscal year ended on a high note, officials indicated that the target for the current fiscal (FY27) remains under review. Given the various economic scenarios and the series of tax concessions recently announced, the ministry plans to conduct a fresh assessment to calibrate revenue expectations for the year ahead.

Without giving actual figures, the official said that revenues from customs duty came in at 102 per cent of RE, while it was 101 per cent of RE for excise duty.

The Central GST collection came in at 100.8 per cent of RE for FY26. "Overall, GST plus non-GST collection came in at 101.2 per cent of RE," the official said.

CESS COLLECTION
However, the collection from health and national se-

KEY DATA

- Total indirect tax collection, which includes customs, excise and GST, as per RE was pegged at over ₹15.52 lakh crore for FY26
- Revenues from customs duty came in at 102 per cent of RE, while it was 101 per cent of RE for excise duty
- In the Budget Estimates for 2026-27, Gross Tax Revenue was pegged at ₹44.04 lakh crore, representing a growth of 8 per cent over RE 2025-26

curity cess, which is levied on *pan masala* manufacturing, has missed the target. The RE had pegged ₹2,330 crore from the health and national security cess collection in FY26. However, the actual collections for FY26 came in lower at 63 per cent of RE. The cess is levied over and above the highest 40 per cent GST rate

The official said that the collection from the cess is expected to improve in the current fiscal as the levy settles in.

For the current fiscal, the government has budgeted to collect ₹14,000 crore from the cess. The total indirect

tax collection, which includes customs, excise and GST, as per RE was pegged at over ₹15.52 lakh crore for FY26.

This includes ₹2.58 lakh crore from customs duty, ₹3.38 lakh crore from excise duty, and ₹9.58 lakh crore from Central Goods and Services Tax (CGST).

REVENUE COLLECTION
Meanwhile, when asked about revenue collection from indirect taxes this fiscal, officials said that it was too early to talk about impact; and there were a lot of uncertainties too, they added. "Because of the global

India seeks preferential market access over competitors as part of the US trade deal

Amiti Sen
New Delhi



Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal said that India wants preferential market access in the US as part of the interim bilateral trade agreement (BTA) being finalised so that it maintains an edge over competitor countries.

"Our trade deal is in place. As long as we get preferential access, we can go ahead with it. That preferential access has to be sorted out through further steps and action. At present, we are all at 10 per cent (uniform tariffs imposed

by the US after its Supreme Court invalidated reciprocal tariffs)," Goyal told reporters on Thursday.

Earlier this year, India and the US agreed on the framework for an interim BTA. As part of the framework, Washington offered to bring down reciprocal tariffs on India to 18 per cent, which was

slightly lower than those on competing countries such as Bangladesh, Vietnam and Indonesia. The pact was not formally signed.

After the US Supreme Court invalidated all reciprocal tariffs, the US imposed a uniform tariff of 10 per cent on all trading partners for a period of 90 days.

SWEET SPOT
Goyal said India's trade pact with the US is "best" as compared to its competitor countries, adding that India was sitting on a very "sweet spot" in promoting its trade with the US. "Our relations are very ro-

bust. We have a deep strategic partnership on several aspects, on technology, on defence, on trade and on investments, and our approach is that India should get preferential market access," Goyal said.

He added that India's trade deals with other partner countries were well on track. India's free trade agreement with the UK is expected to operationalise within the next 30-45 days, he said.

The free trade deal with New Zealand is likely to be signed in the fourth week of April, while the one with Oman could possibly kick in on May 1, the Minister said.

Centre considers more support for exporters as West Asia tensions drive up freight costs

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The government is considering additional measures to help exporters cope with disruptions arising from the West Asia crisis, including a possible extension of freight subsidies, as many are being forced to take longer shipping routes, officials said.

"The government has already announced measures to help exporters tackle the impact of the West Asia crisis, and some more decisions are on the anvil," Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal said

on Thursday. An official said that while relief has been extended on insurance, the government is now examining the possibility of easing the burden of elevated freight rates, which have risen sharply for several destinations.

"All ministries and departments concerned are looking at various ways in which assistance can be extended to industry to cope with the crisis," the official said.

TRADE IMPACT
Goyal said he discussed the geopolitical situation in bilateral meetings with trade

All ministries and departments are looking at various ways to extend assistance to industry

ministers on the sidelines of the WTO ministerial meeting in Cameroon.

"It has hurt the global economy. It is hurting global trade. The death and destruction of property and innocent lives is something that we are all concerned about. The difficulties in the free movement of goods

across open seas is another issue we are collectively hoping can be resolved quickly," he said.

India, however, has shown resilience on food and energy security, Goyal added.

"Consumers are getting their LPG. Industrial LNG supplies have been reinstated to about 80 per cent, with several sectors receiving full supply. There is no shortage of petroleum products. Our refineries are operating at full capacity. There are sufficient crude oil stocks, and fresh shipments of crude oil, LPG and LNG are ensuring supply continuity," he said.

Govt pushes PNG expansion to 30 lakh connections

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

As the West Asia conflict continues to impact LPG supplies with no near-term respite, the Ministries of Petroleum & Natural Gas (MoPNG), and Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA) on Thursday held a review meeting to focus on piped natural gas (PNG) expansion in more than 150 high-priority districts, targeting 30 lakh connections.

Oil Secretary Neeraj Mittal and MoHUA Secretary Srinivas Katikithala chaired the review meeting through video conferencing with State Urban Development Secretaries, State Civil Supplies Departments, District Magistrates and Municipal

Commissioners/Executive Officers of Urban Local Bodies, MoHUA said. Poll-bound States such as Tamil Nadu and West Bengal were not part of the meeting, it added.

PRIORITISING PNG
"The meeting focused on accelerating the expansion of PNG infrastructure in 110 identified geographical areas, while also strengthening last-mile connectivity in view of the evolving geopolitical situation in West Asia," MoHUA said. The deliberations also focused on the need to prioritise providing household PNG connections in areas where pipeline infrastructure is already in place, with a focus on targeting nearly 30 lakh connections in such areas, it added.

War effect: LNG imports from Qatar drop to record low in March

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

Import of liquefied natural gas (LNG) from India's largest supplier, Qatar, declined to its lowest on record in March with the closure of the Strait of Hormuz (SoH).

Besides, Iran's attack on QatarEnergy's LNG facilities led to declaration of *force majeure* and production shutdowns early last month, further exacerbating India's natural gas imports, which account for roughly half of its consumption.

India's total natural gas consumption is about 189 million standard cubic metres per day (mscmd) with 97.5 mscmd produced domestically. About 47.4 mscmd has

been affected due to *force majeure* conditions.

Global real-time data and analytics provider Kpler pointed out that India remains materially exposed to West Asia, with a significant share of its LNG imports tied to long-term contracts with QatarEnergy.

International Energy Agency (IEA) estimates that global LNG supply has reduced by around 20 per cent due to the situation.

The disruption of transit via the SoH reduced supplies from Qatar and the UAE by over 300 mscmd since March 1.

Sehul Bhatt, Director at Crisil Intelligence, said, "In March, spot prices of Asian LNG nearly doubled to \$20-25 per million British thermal units (mBtu). We



expect the prices to remain elevated and volatile in April as well."

RECORD-LOW IMPORTS
Sonal Ranjan, Kpler's In-sight Analyst for LNG & Natural Gas, told *businessline*, "In January 2026, Qatar supplied around 1 million tonne (mt) of LNG, accounting for roughly 41 per cent of total imports. This fell sharply to 0.06 mt (about 3

per cent share) by March — a 94.3 per cent decline."

To offset the shortfall, imports from the US and Nigeria increased. The US volumes rose to around 0.34 mt in March (up around 144 per cent from January), while Nigeria supplied roughly 0.33 mt (up around 17 per cent).

Oman remained a steady supplier and emerged as the largest source in March at around 0.53 mt, she added.

"Overall, total monthly LNG imports declined around 35 per cent from January to March, driven by elevated spot prices and constraints on physical supply," Ranjan pointed out.

IMPACT ON QATAR
The Ras Laffan facility in Qatar, which is the world's

largest liquefaction facility, has been offline since it was first attacked on March 2.

Sourcing becomes the next battle ground, as markets remained tight during January-February 2026, and depleted storage coming out of the heating season in the Northern Hemisphere is set to increase the call on LNG in the months ahead.

Besides, the extended loss of output from QatarEnergy's Ras Laffan facility could significantly exacerbate this market tightness, IEA said.

About 93 per cent of Qatar's and 96 per cent of the UAE's LNG exports transited through the Strait, representing almost one-fifth of global LNG trade.

In 2025, almost 90 per cent of the total volumes ex-

ported via the SoH was destined for the Asian market. Just over 10 per cent went to Europe. Countries that have long-term contracts with the UAE or Qatar would need to turn to the spot market for LNG, which would drive up natural gas prices around the world.

QatarEnergy said it expects the damage to its Ras Laffan Industrial City caused by missile strikes on March 18-19 to cost about \$20 billion a year in lost revenue and take up to five years to repair, impacting supply to markets in Europe and Asia. Damage sustained by LNG facilities will take three-five years to repair. The attacks have also pushed offline around 1.281 mt LPG, which is roughly 13 per cent of Qatar's exports.

Refiners to direct a portion of LPG feedstock to pharma, food sectors

Our Bureau
New Delhi



Sujata Sharma, Joint Secretary, Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas

Strait of Hormuz. She was speaking at the daily inter-ministerial briefing on West Asia.

"Certain other sectors which also need some of these molecules are facing a shortage and thereby this decision has been taken," Sharma added.

WINDFALL TAX
The Department of Revenue also clarified that the wind-

fall tax on jet fuel and diesel will not be applicable to Reliance Industries (RIL) SEZ refinery.

"As per judicial pronouncements on this issue, the special additional excise duty and additional excise duty are not applicable on SEZ refineries," said JS Kandhari, Joint Secretary in the Department of Revenue.

The government reinstated the windfall tax, first introduced in 2022, amid disruptions to global energy supplies caused by the West Asia conflict.

Sharma emphasised that there is no shortage of petrol and diesel in the country and the regular retail prices for the two auto fuels is unchanged.

This is despite the PSU oil marketing companies' under recovery rising to ₹24.40 per litre on petrol and ₹104.99 on diesel.

Hormuz crisis chokes shipping, sends freight rates soaring five-fold

T E Raja Simhan
Chennai

More than a month into the West Asia crisis, triggered by the US-Iran conflict, shipping and trade remain in deep turmoil, marked by extreme volatility and uncertainty.

The disruption of the Strait of Hormuz — a critical artery for global energy flows — has severely impacted maritime traffic, pushing freight rates up nearly five-fold, inflating war-risk insurance premiums by 10x and the imposition of emergency surcharges across key trade lanes.

Prior to the crisis, around 150 vessels transited the strait daily; that number has now dropped to just four or five. Similarly, deliveries are now arriving two-three weeks behind schedule, as vessels reroute via longer passages such as the Cape of Good Hope, increasing both

transit time and costs. The United Nations said on Tuesday that nearly 2,000 ships, including oil and gas tankers, bulk carriers, cargo vessels and six cruise liners, with close to 20,000 seafarers, are stranded in the Persian Gulf, unable to pass through the narrow strait amid the ongoing conflict.

Iran, which borders the waterway to the north, has said passage will be allowed only to "non-hostile" ships.

Cargo movement to West Asia has come to a near halt following the suspension of services across parts of the region, while outbound shipments to the US and Europe continue to face significant delays.

The UAE remains India's largest trading partner in the region, with bilateral trade nearing \$90 billion. India's exports to the UAE, including engineering goods, pharmaceuticals, textiles and leather products, account for nearly \$40 billion, with over



HIT BY CRISIS. Earlier, around 150 vessels transited the Strait of Hormuz daily, which has dropped to four or five now. REUTERS

90 per cent transported by sea.

TRADE IMPACT
Industry experts said the prolonged confrontation is reshaping global logistics.

J Krishnan, Partner at Chennai-based S Natesa Iyer Logistics LLP, noted that supply chain disruptions have hit Indian trade, both inbound and outbound, with cancellations and detours around Africa extending voyage times and inflating costs. Container shortages are fur-

ther constraining trade flows.

Jagannarayan Padmanabhan of CRISIL Intelligence described the situation as a structural shift away from "efficiency-first" maritime trade toward a regime of "selective transit," where shipping routes are increasingly influenced by geopolitics.

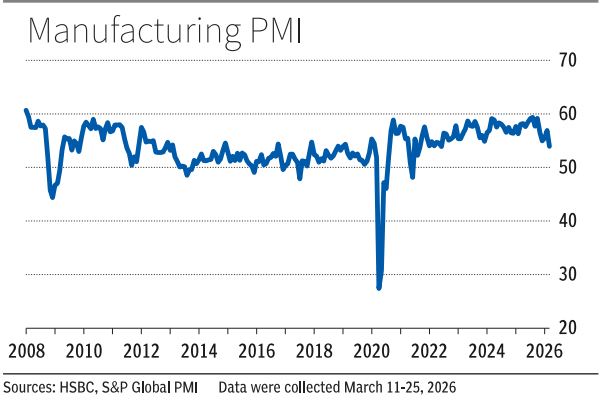
War-risk premiums for a single Gulf transit have surged from about 0.2 per cent to as high as 3-4 per cent of vessel value, significantly altering the economics of

global shipping. For India, this amounts to a systemic "logistics tax," raising the landed cost of crude shipments and effectively tightening global fleet availability.

Exporters are already feeling the strain. Kumar Duraisamy, Managing Director of the Tiruppur-based Eastern Global Clothing, said operational costs have risen nearly five-fold, with transit times to the US stretching to 45-70 days from about a month earlier.

Ram Ganesan, Managing Director of Madurai-based Paramount Textiles, added that freight rates on some routes had surged up to 400 per cent.

Disruptions in key maritime corridors had slowed cargo movement to Europe and the Gulf — major markets for Indian textiles — affecting trade volumes. Rising energy, shipping and raw material costs are expected to push retail garment prices up by 15-20 per cent.



M CH-CHE

QUICKLY.

Bharti Airtel ends higher, Kotak upgrades to 'Buy'



Mumbai: Bharti Airtel, which remained under pressure in early deal on Thursday, regained strength to end 0.44 per cent higher at at ₹1,789.70 on the NSE. Kotak Institutional Equities upgraded the stock to 'Buy' with a target price of ₹2,250. During the day, it hit a high of ₹1,799.40 and a low of 1,746.90. Kotak cited resilient wireless performance, near-term ARPU hike potential, and significantly lower capex intensity — projected at 21-22 per cent of revenue over FY26-28 versus a historical 30 per cent. The brokerage also said concerns around capital allocation in Airtel's NBFC business were overdone, with the stock now trading at an attractive 8x EV/EBITDA on FY2028 estimates. **OUR BUREAU**

Ganesh Consumer Products up on promoter stake buy

Mumbai: Shares of Ganesh Consumer Products closed 3.43 per cent higher on Thursday on the NSE after the company disclosed that its promoter and Managing Director, Manish Mimani, purchased 2,95,314 shares through open market transactions on March 31. The stock of Kolkata-based packaged staple food company closed at ₹180.30, up from the previous close of ₹174.32. The disclosure revealed that Mimani's stake rose to 5.74 per cent, while overall promoter and promoter group holding increased from 64.08 per cent to 64.81 per cent. **OUR BUREAU**

BROKER'S CALL.

Emkay Global

INTERGLOBE AVIATION (BUY)
Target: ₹5,500
CMP: ₹4,194.10

The first ATF price revision after the start of the West Asia conflict saw high frenzy—OMCs (OOL) initially hiked domestic/international rates by 115 per cent/107 per cent month on month to ₹207/\$1.7 per litre, followed by the announcement of domestic scheduled airlines' rate revision by only about 25 per cent to ₹105/litre. OMCs seem to have taken the hit for now. Post this, Indigo has revised its fuel surcharge rates effective April 2, with domestic fares ranging from ₹275 to ₹950 for distances covering 0-500 km to over 2,000 km, with the average likely to be similar to the March 14 rate of about ₹400. However, international fuel surcharge is hiked materially, from ₹425-2,300 for the South Asia-Europe route to ₹900-10,000. Based on Indigo's average stage length, we estimate about a 20 per cent rise in the base fare/RASK vs a 50 per cent rise in blended fuel cost, with PBT spreads improving from pre-conflict levels; this can offset the slowdown in pax volumes and RPK (13-14 per cent of ASK deployed in the conflict-hit Gulf). While earnings visibility is low amid the current macro volatility, we cut FY26/27/28E EPS by 13 per cent/28 per cent/7 per cent and cut our TP by 13 per cent to ₹5,500 from ₹6,300, valuing the airline at 20x March 2028E EPS. Given Indigo's dominant position in India's aviation market and the past precedence of emerging stronger from a crisis situation (Covid, Russia-Ukraine war) and with leadership largely in place, maintain BUY on the stock.

JM Financial

CARTRADE TECH (BUY)
Target: ₹2,380
CMP: ₹1,690.55

A recent interaction with CarTrade management highlights the company's increasing focus on building an AI-led, transaction-oriented platform, with initiatives spanning SuperDost — enabling buyers and sellers to connect directly, allowing relevant matchmaking by simply uploading a car's photo or prompting a query, along with integration of CarVale and OLX through a unified C2B product aimed at improving cross-platform play. The company is also introducing WhatsApp-based vernacular interfaces to drive mass adoption, alongside adjacencies such as fintech, C2C transaction logistics/escrow, etc. These efforts indicate a clear push towards improving monetisation through integrated AI capabilities, but visibility on the timeline and financial impact remains limited. We will wait for the actual impact on numbers before building it into our estimates. While there certainly is a huge opportunity in B2C/C2B/C2C segments, almost the entirety of the company's revenue comes from B2B clients. While we don't change our revenue estimates across segments as factoring in AI initiatives in financials without tangible proof of execution will be premature, we have raised EBITDA estimates by 1-1.5 per cent over FY26-29E. We value CarTrade based on SoTP valuation to arrive at a lower March 2027 TP of ₹2,380. But the sharp correction turns risk-reward favourable with CMP near the bear-case scenario. We maintain Buy with March 27 TP implying a c.26x FY28E EBITDA multiple.

businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: blmarketwatch@gmail.com

Nifty claws back 500 points from day's low after a volatile session

DOWNGRADE BANDWAGON. After Goldman Sachs, UBS and Bernstein, Nomura also cuts Nifty target

Anupama Ghosh
Mumbai

Markets staged a dramatic intra-day turnaround on Thursday with the Nifty 50 recovering over 500 points from its session low to close marginally higher, as geopolitics, crude oil and a surprise rupee rally collided in one of the most volatile sessions of the year.

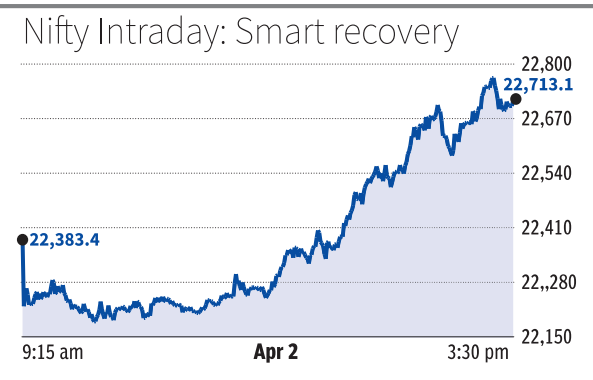
The BSE Sensex closed at 73,319.55, up 185.23 points or 0.25 per cent, while the Nifty 50 settled at 22,713.10, gaining 33.70 points or 0.15 per cent. The numbers, however, masked the turbulence beneath. The Nifty had earlier slipped over 2 per cent after the US President Donald Trump said the US would hit Iran hard in the next two-

three weeks, dashing hopes of an early ceasefire. Brent crude spiked 5.8 per cent to around \$107 per barrel on fears of supply disruptions through the Strait of Hormuz.

CAUTIOUS MOOD
Analysts still remain sceptical on market recovery, as the Iran war continues to trigger risk-off sentiment.

"Market sentiment is expected to remain volatile, with direction contingent on developments in the US-Iran conflict over the weekend and movements in global energy prices," said Siddhartha Khemka, Head of Research at Motilal Oswal Financial Services.

Meanwhile, Nomura also downgraded India to "Neutral" and cut its Nifty50 year-



end target to 24,500.

Multiple headwinds ranging from elevated energy prices to the AI capex momentum and the tech cycle are likely to impact, said the global investment advisory firm. Earlier, Goldman Sachs, Bernstein and UBS had downgraded Indian equities.

For the week, Nifty and Sensex declined 0.5 per cent and 0.4 per cent. BSE Midcap 150 underperformed the benchmarks (down 0.6 per cent week on week), while the BSE Smallcap 250 outperformed the benchmarks (rose 0.8 per cent WoW), said SBI Securities in a note.

Franklin Templeton cuts cash holding, fully invested

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Franklin Templeton Asset Management (India) has reduced its cash position substantially and remains fully invested in equity even as the markets went on a topsy-turvy ride.

The sharp fall in key indices and the bearish sentiment amid the raging war in West Asia will have a major impact on inflows through Systematic Investment Plans, he said.

LONG VIEW
Avinash Satwalekar, President, Franklin Templeton India, said the fund house believes in its portfolio



Avinash Satwalekar, President, Franklin Templeton India

worrying about negative returns in the last two years and market volatility.

"I know it is not a pleasant situation when SIP returns turn negative, particularly when the whole notion is about keep putting money in SIP to make more money," he said on the sidelines of an event to launch the fund house's equity long-short SIF under Sapphire SIF.

SIP DISCIPLINE

What most investors tend to do is cancel SIP, and they are technically averaging down. By doing this, he said they miss out on the opportunity to buy more units for the same rupee, and when the market turns, they will re-

main a laggard for long, he added.

"Markets give an opportunity every five years to truly put money to work. If you do not take that opportunity, you will get rich, but you will not get wealthy. How do you create real wealth is to do something when others are not doing it," said Satwalekar.

FLEXIBLE STRATEGY

On the new long-short equity SIF launched, he said investors are navigating markets that move through different phases rapidly, making disciplined and flexible investment strategies increasingly important.

Compared to conven-

SECTORAL SHOW

IT was the lone sectoral gainer, rising 2.6 per cent, while auto, PSU banks, oil & gas, pharma and consumer durables each shed approximately 1 per cent. Broader markets lagged, with Midcap and Smallcap indices declining 0.3 per cent and 0.4 per cent, respectively. Bank Nifty ended at 51,548.75, up a modest 0.19 per cent.

The week ahead is packed with triggers. The RBI MPC meeting takes centre stage — a rate pause is widely expected, but commentary on the rate trajectory matters against a backdrop of a four-year-low Manufacturing PMI and crude-driven inflation risks. The US March CPI print and weekly jobless claims will also be in focus, said Khemka.

Bank Nifty hits year low on RBI measures, analysts see impact on asset quality

Madhu Balaji
Bengaluru



The index rebounded after a gap-down opening to end marginally higher at 51,549

Nifty Bank index hits its lowest level in nearly a year, as concerns mounted over potential losses following the RBI's tighter curbs on speculative activity in the rupee market. However, the index rebounded sharply due to overall market sentiment, ending marginally higher by 0.19 per cent at 51,549.

During the session, it fell as much as 2.9 per cent to 49,954.85, its weakest level since April 2025, with all constituents trading in the red. On April 7, 2025, it stood at 49860.1. The correction in Bank Nifty, driven by the RBI's forex market crackdown, according to Vikram Kasat, Head Advisory at PL Capital, is impacting banks' treasury income and forcing mark-to-market (MTM) losses. Kasat noted that while the central bank's actions are helping stabilise the rupee, they are triggering unwinding of positions in the FX market, leading to near-term pressure on banking stocks despite improving macro stability.

Among individual stocks, HDFC Bank, Kotak Mahindra Bank, ICICI Bank, SBI and Axis Bank recovered to settle with mild gains. Meanwhile, IndusInd Bank, AU Small Finance Bank, Bank of Baroda and Yes Bank slipped.

Recently, the Reserve Bank of India barred banks from offering rupee non-deliverable forwards to both resident and non-resident clients. This came shortly after it imposed a cap of \$100 million on banks' net open rupee positions, tightening their ability to take speculative bets.

MARGIN PRESSURE

According to analysts, concerns over asset quality are

Powerica ends at ₹390, down 1.2% on Day 1

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Powerica shares made a weak debut on the stock exchanges on Thursday, and closed at ₹390, down 1.2 per cent below the issue price of ₹395, after posting

On the NSE, the stock listed at a 7.3 per cent discount at ₹366 compared to the offer price of ₹395, and on the BSE, it opened at a 5 per cent discount at ₹375. During the day, the stock touched a high of ₹396.85 and a low of ₹365.10 on the BSE.

Ravi Singh, Chief Research Officer (Research) at Master Capital Services, advised investors with a long-term view can consider holding the stock, while those with a cautious approach may wait for some price stability before making fresh investments.

DECENT DEMAND

The ₹1,100-crore initial public offering of Powerica saw a decent response from investors, with an overall sub-



Bharat Naresh Oberoi, JMD, Powerica (left), and Ashishkumar Chauhan, MD & CEO of NSE, at the listing event

scription of 1.53 times. The IPO was priced in the range of ₹375 to ₹395 per share and comprised a fresh issue of up to ₹700 crore along with an offer-for-sale of up to ₹400 crore by promoters, including the Naresh Oberoi Family Trust and Kabir and Kimaya Family Private Trust.

Ahead of the public issue, the company raised ₹329.40 crore from anchor investors, allocating 83,39,239 equity shares at ₹395 apiece. Participation from prominent institutional investors such as SBI Mutual Fund, ICICI Prudential Mutual Fund, HDFC Mutual Fund, Kotak

Mutual Fund and others, along with insurance players like Kotak Mahindra Life Insurance, Edelweiss Life Insurance and Reliance Nippon Life Insurance, highlighted institutional interest in the offering.

USE OF FUNDS

Proceeds from the fresh issue are slated to be used primarily for debt repayment and general corporate purposes. Powerica operates as an integrated power solutions provider with a generator set business driven by Cummins-powered DG sets and large generators developed in collaboration with Hyundai.

The company also has a presence in the wind energy segment as an independent power producer and EPC contractor. Powerica owns and operates 12 wind power projects in Gujarat with a total installed capacity of 330.85 MW. It is also in the process of developing an additional 52.70 MW project, which will take its total capacity to 383.55 MW.

TVS Venu Group acquires PGIM India Asset Management

Our Bureau
Mumbai

TVS Venu Group has entered into definitive agreements to acquire Prudential Financial Inc's entire stake in PGIM India Asset Management and PGIM India Trustees.

The deal being executed through TVS Venu Management and Consultancy Services and its affiliates is subject to regulatory approvals and other customary closing conditions.

BIZ OFFERING

PGIM India is a wholly-owned business of PGIM, the global investment management business of PFI. It is a full-service investment manager offering a broad range of equity, fixed income and multi-asset solutions to retail and institutional investors, managing over ₹30,000 crore of assets as of

December-end. Khaitan & Co acted as legal advisor to the TVS Venu Group, and Shardul Amarchand Mangaldas & Co acted as the legal advisor to PFI. Ernst & Young LLP acted as the exclusive M&A advisor to PFI.

It manages 25 open-ended mutual funds in India as of March-end and also offers alternative investment funds, portfolio management services and offshore advisory.

In 2019, Prudential Global Investment Managers completed the purchase of a 50 per cent stake held by its joint venture partner DHFL.

The fund house, earlier known as DHFL Pramerica Asset Managers, was changed to PGIM India Mutual Fund.

PGIM India currently manages over ₹27,000 crore in assets under management.

Sai Parenterals gains 4% on listing day

Our Bureau
Bengaluru



HEALTHY BEGINNING. Sai Parenteral officials and family members at the listing ceremony of company shares. The stock closed at ₹406.40 on the BSE against IPO price of ₹392

Sai Parenterals shares made a steady debut on the stock exchanges on Thursday, listing at a modest premium to the issue price.

On the BSE, the stock opened at ₹405, reflecting a 3 per cent premium over the issue price of ₹392. On the NSE, it listed at ₹400, up 2 per cent.

The stock closed at ₹405.70 on the NSE and ₹406.40 on the BSE.

Ravi Singh, Chief Research Officer (Research) at Master Capital Services, said the company is well-positioned, backed by its diversified formulations portfolio, strong CDMO capabilities, and expanding presence in regulated and semi-regulated markets.

IPO SUBSCRIPTION

Singh advised investors who were allotted shares to consider holding them for the long term, citing the steady growth outlook of the in-

dustry. The ₹409-crore initial public offering of Sai Parenterals Ltd was subscribed 1.05 times.

The qualified institutional buyers segment was subscribed 1.71 times, while the non-institutional investors portion saw a better response of 2.36 times. Retail participation, however, remained subdued at 0.12 times. Ahead of the IPO, the company mobilised over ₹122 crore from anchor investors.

The IPO comprised a combination of fresh issue and an offer-for-sale. The fresh issue aggregated up to ₹285 crore, while the OFS saw off-

loading by existing shareholders, including Vikasa India EIF I Fund and others. The price band for the issue was fixed at ₹372 to ₹392 per share.

BUSINESS EXPANSION

Proceeds from the fresh issue are intended to support the company's expansion strategy, particularly in strengthening its global formulations business and enhancing its Contract Development and Manufacturing Organisation capabilities. The focus remains on scaling up both injectable products and oral solid dosage manufacturing.

Amir Chand hits lower circuit after weak debut

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Shares of basmati rice exporter Amir Chand Jagdish Kumar (Exports) Ltd came under heavy selling pressure on listing day on Thursday.

The stock debuted at ₹195 on the BSE, down 8.02 per cent from the IPO price of ₹212. On the NSE, it opened at ₹200, down 5.66 per cent.

Selling intensified during the session, and the stock closed at ₹180 on the NSE and at ₹175.50 on the BSE, marking a sharp fall of about 10 per cent below the listing price.

ABOUT THE IPO

The ₹440-crore initial public offering of the company was subscribed 3.23 times on the final day of bidding on March 27.

The issue was priced in the range of ₹201 to ₹212 per share and comprised entirely a fresh issue, with no offer-

for-sale component.

The company plans to utilise the IPO proceeds primarily for working capital requirements and general corporate purposes.

Notably, the final issue size was scaled down to ₹440 crore from the ₹550 crore proposed in the draft papers filed earlier.

Ravi Singh, Chief Research Officer (Research) at Master Capital Services, said he expects the company's liquidity to gradually increase, making it more suitable for long-term, growth-oriented portfolios looking to get exposure to India's rice market.

According to Shivani Nyati, Head of Wealth at Swastika Investmart, the stock may remain volatile with a negative bias in the near term due to post-listing selling pressure.

Amir Chand Jagdish Kumar (Exports) Ltd is a processor and exporter of basmati rice under the flagship brand Aeroplane.

Nifty 50 Movers					▲ 33.70 pts.
	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	WN(%)	
HDFC Bank	750.90	28.88	14.93	11.04	
Infosys	1300.80	19.20	18.84	4.38	
ICICI Tech	1402.20	11.00	23.10	1.42	
TCS	2450.70	9.47	18.49	2.40	
Bajaj Finance	626.85	5.57	28.08	2.12	
Bharti Airtel	1789.70	5.22	29.43	5.28	
Tech Mahindra	1441.50	5.12	30.76	0.88	
ICICI Bank	1215.80	4.84	15.38	8.35	
Hindalco	916.25	3.68	12.81	1.27	
Maretti Suzuki	1283.00	3.48	26.60	1.59	
Kotak Bank	358.00	3.13	18.94	2.53	
Axis Bank	1197.90	3.00	14.09	3.30	
Titan	4097.20	2.85	76.32	1.62	
TataConsumerProduct	1042.00	2.59	70.07	0.65	
ITC	292.85	2.42	17.72	2.71	
Wipro	194.91	2.33	15.53	0.54	
Bharat Elec	421.60	2.27	51.68	1.45	
NestleIndia	1191.30	1.64	70.43	0.82	
L&T	3613.10	1.43	26.19	4.07	
Trent Ltd.	3550.60	1.17	77.92	0.76	
Dr Reddys Lab.	1217.30	1.02	18.40	0.71	
InterglobeAvi	4193.50	0.63	50.49	0.91	
State Bank	105.40	0.58	10.48	4.06	
Apollo Hosp	7317.50	0.27	56.39	0.72	
JSW Steel	1141.30	0.18	35.94	1.03	
Tata Motors PV	303.30	0.16	41.25	0.61	
Hind Unilever	2065.30	0.12	48.26	1.76	
Coal India	449.35	-0.02	9.31	0.98	
Cipla	1192.40	-0.43	21.25	0.64	
Adani Enter	1834.20	-0.47	14.98	1.46	
ONGC	287.20	-0.72	8.03	1.07	
Bajaj Finserv	1640.70	-0.79	13.68	0.91	
Tata Steel	194.14	-0.83	26.57	1.54	
Adani Ports	1377.60	-1.26	25.40	0.98	
Adani Power	566.10	-1.61	64.62	0.58	
SBI Life	1774.70	-1.64	71.77	0.37	
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	229.48	-1.75	90.85	0.72	
Max Healthcare	944.60	-2.32	64.77	0.68	
Grassim Ind	2564.10	-2.38	18.42	0.94	
UltraTech Cement	10620.00	-2.43	40.84	1.21	
Shriram Finance Ltd.	891.60	-2.73	13.84	1.20	
PowerGrid Corp	208.95	-2.82	17.37	1.26	
Bajaj Grid Corp	8758.50	-3.31	21.75	0.93	
M&M	3011.70	-3.86	22.16	2.59	
NTPC	359.65	-5.17	14.05	1.64	
Eicher Motors	6649.50	-5.28	34.05	0.88	
Asian Paints	2169.00	-5.60	53.21	0.94	
Eternal Ltd.	231.72	-7.54	968.04	1.80	
Sun Pharma	809.10	-8.06	57.10	1.32	
Reliance Ind	1350.50	-27.56	18.69	8.76	

Pts: Impact on index movement

Nifty Next 50 Movers					▲ 44.85 pts.
	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	WN(%)	
LtIntimtree	4303.90	51.57	27.01	1.82	
Vedanta	687.65	50.13	16.23	5.32	
AvenueSuper	4362.40	37.95	99.11	2.93	
Bosch	32135.00	36.73	34.38	1.27	
Adani Power	159.97	33.39	27.30	3.01	
Tata Power	385.00	22.68	24.56	2.94	
Dif	522.25	22.64	29.19	1.53	
Solar Industries	13109.00	20.77	77.70	1.45	
Power Finance	402.25	18.70	3.98	2.67	
Union Bank	231.99	1.81	6.93	1.51	
ZydusHisciences	864.25	0.74	17.30	0.99	
Jindal Steel	1137.90	0.52	57.58	1.92	
Siemens Energy India	2612.00	-0.47	78.74	1.05	
Cg Power & Ind Sol	680.05	-0.48	96.53	2.13	
Indian Railway Finance Corp	91.84	-0.85	17.13	0.84	
Hyundai Motor India	1711.50	-1.89	24.02	1.11	
Bpel	127.04	-			
Canara Bank	994.80	-2.12	55.88	1.85	
Ambuga Cements	438.45	-3.27	21.02	1.16	
Shree Cement	2319.00	-5.29	46.45	1.41	
Indian Hotels Co.	582.75	-6.07	38.33	2.23	
Sanmaradhotsonintermatl	106.81	-10.12	30.98	2.15	
Britannia Ind	5442.00	-10.64	54.24	2.92	
Hindus Zinc	515.75	-10.55	18.46	1.02	
Mazdaagon Dock	2264.60	-11.50	37.96	0.78	
Bank Of Baroda	249.56	-12.94	6.57	2.11	
Adani Energy Solutions	941.60	-14.69	67.45	1.49	
Indian Oilcorp	134.00	-16.77	62.75	1.51	
Bpel	278.15	-17.74	4.90	2.57	
Dvci Ltd	5856.50	-17.94	62.72	1.38	
Cholamandalamini&Fin	1356.30	-20.92	23.84	2.65	
Tvs Motor Corp.	3391.40	-22.81	52.76	3.63	
Muthofin	1111.80	-23.37	14.75	1.55	
United Spirits	3278.20	-23.43	51.64	1.64	
India Infratech	1273.60	-29.24	56.01	1.91	
Torrent Pharma	388.70	-36.64	99.39	3.90	
Tata Motors Cv	398.10	-46.90	86.79	1.70	
Pts: Impact on index movement					

CONSTITUENCY WATCH: RASHBEHARI

Amid widespread discontent among people, BJP and TMC set for poll battle

THE HEAT IS ON. Deletion of voters’ names and allegations of corruption will test the outcome when the constituency votes on April 29

Mithun Dasgupta
Kolkata

It has been a year since West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee inaugurated the longest skywalk in Kolkata that connects the city’s high-traffic arterial Syama Prasad Mukherjee Road and Kalighat temple, which is among the holiest places of worship in the country.

After four years of construction, the skywalk, built at a cost of over ₹80 crore, was inaugurated on the eve of *Poila Baishak*, the Bengali new year, to improve urban infrastructure and facilitate better crowd management during peak pilgrimage seasons.

NOT IMPRESSED

Shop owners surrounding the skywalk and the historic Kali temple and the locals are, however, not enthused, calling the construction unnecessary and a waste of taxpayers’ money.

Some even alleged that most of the money ended up in the pockets of local leaders of the Trinamool Congress.

“We support beautification and restoration of the temple complex. Infrastructure development of this area is also necessary. But construction of this skywalk was absolutely needless. It

remains mostly empty throughout the day. Moreover, even after 8 pm, you would be scared to enter it because of security issues. It does not benefit devotees and locals. It has only helped TMC leaders and workers,” said Suresh Sau, who has a 12-year-old shop near the aerial walkway.

ICONIC KALI TEMPLE

The iconic Kali temple at Kalighat falls under the Rashbehari constituency in South Kolkata. BJP leader Swapan Dasgupta is contesting from the Trinamool stronghold against TMC’s Debasish Kumar, who defeated his BJP rival by around 21,400 votes in the 2021 Assembly polls.

“Corruption has been rampant under the Trinamool Congress rule in Bengal. There are several instances of crime against women by Trinamool goons. In most of these cases, the culprits went unpunished. TMC depends on dole politics. They are seeking votes for schemes like Lakshmir Bhandar and Yuva Sathi. But there is widespread discontent among the people,” said a resident who did not wish to be named.

This person, a trader of metals, said the BJP had a weak organisation in the Rashbehari constituency. “Even with only three weeks left before the elections, we



LOCAL CONNECT. BJP candidate Swapan Dasgupta campaigns for the Rashbehari Assembly constituency at a local market in Kolkata

are yet to see a large, aggressive campaign by the BJP in some parts of the area,” he added.

The constituency will go to the polls in the second phase of the elections, scheduled for April 29.

SIR GOOF UP

The seat, carved largely from the wards of the Kolkata Municipal Corporation, reflects the city’s social diversity, with affluent neighbourhoods, such as Gariahat and

Ballygunge, as well as mixed-income neighbourhoods such as Kalighat and Rashbehari. The constituency saw a deletion of around 42,000 voters as on February 28 when the Election Commission released the final electoral roll after the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) in the State.

“In this deletion, most were deceased, duplicate, permanently shifted or fake voters. I don’t think the deletion of voters under SIR was

politically motivated. During our door-to-door campaign in this constituency, I have found that people have huge resentment over various scams and crimes against women. The State government is denying people access to Ayushman Bharat, which provides free health insurance coverage to low-income families. I believe we will be able to capitalise on these major issues,” Dasgupta, a former Rajya Sabha member, told *business-*

line. “If you look at the 2024 Lok Sabha election figures, Trinamool secured a lead of only 1,500-1,600 votes from the Rashbehari Assembly segment. We are fighting every inch of the way,” he said.

“We will work for every vote. Visibility of our election campaign will increase significantly in the next few days,” he added.

TMC HOPEFUL OF WIN

Trinamool Congress candidate Kumar remains hopeful of winning the election by a greater margin, backed by the party’s strong organisation and his connection with the people in the constituency.

“Swapan Babu is a prominent figure who is a recipient of the Padma Bhushan award. I hold him in high regard. I am an ordinary person and have only one USP that is being with people 24x7,” said Kumar.

He said anger grew in the constituency over the deletion of some genuine voters from the electoral rolls and putting a large number of electors under the adjudication category. “Initially, around 8,000 voters were under adjudication and among them only 3,500 names have so far been added to the voters’ list. Maybe most of the names that have been deleted were our voters,” Kumar added.

QUICKLY.

‘Congress handed over Kaziranga to infiltrators’

Kaliabor: Union Home Minister Amit Shah on Thursday alleged that the Congress did nothing for Assam’s development during its 15-year rule in the State. Addressing an election rally here, he alleged that the Congress handed over the world-famous Kaziranga National Park to infiltrators, who encroached on forest land and endangered the one-horned rhinoceros. “It was the NDA government that evicted the encroachers and ensured Kaziranga was once again on the world tourism map,” he said. Shah targeted Congress leader Rahul Gandhi, who is on a visit to the poll-bound North-East State on Thursday, saying: “What did the Congress do for the State during its rule? Prime Minister Manmohan Singh represented Assam, but neither the then Central government nor the State government did anything for its development.”

When infiltrators are removed from encroached land, the Congress tries to portray it as faith-based politics, the Union Minister alleged. “I want to make it clear that the BJP is against infiltrators and is not opposed to indigenous Muslims in Assam.” On a two-day visit to the State, Shah campaigned for the BJP’s alliance partner Asom Gana Parishad’s candidate and Minister Keshab Mahanta in Kaliabor.

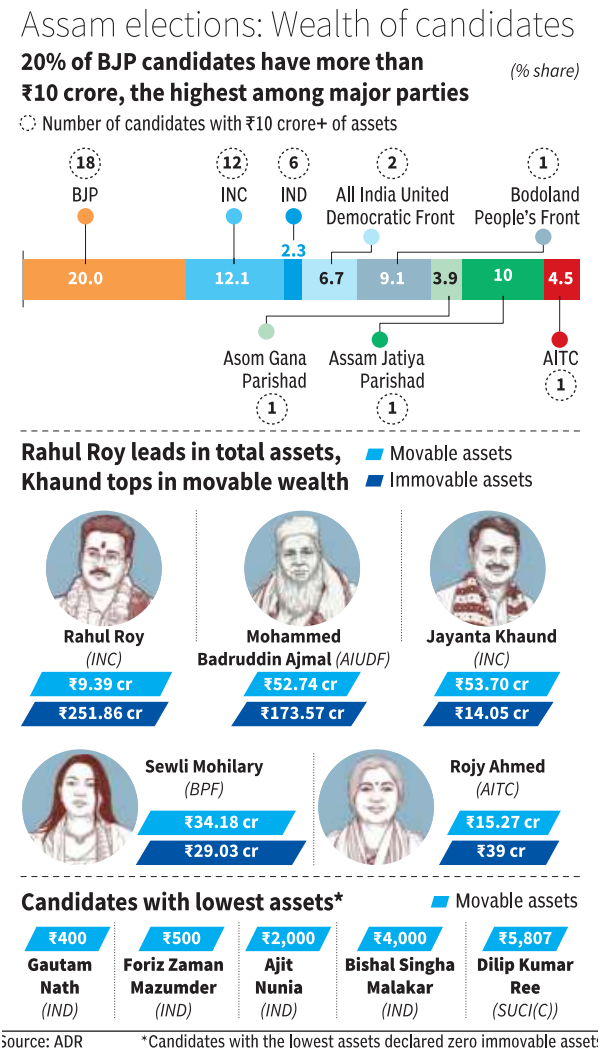


Revanth Reddy invites Kerala CM to study Telangana’s evolution

Kochi: Telangana Chief Minister Revanth Reddy has invited Kerala Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan to visit Telangana and assess the implementation of promises made in the Congress manifesto. Reddy said that all necessary arrangements, including a special aircraft, would be made for Vijayan’s visit.

He added that Finance Minister Sridhar Babu, who played a key role in preparing the Telangana manifesto, would accompany the Kerala Chief Minister to explain how the Congress government has executed its guarantees. Responding to Vijayan’s criticism of Telangana’s poll promises, Reddy stated that over 25 lakh farmers had benefited from agricultural loan schemes.

He said that within 14 months of assuming office, the government made 67,173 appointments. Additionally, more than 50 lakh families have benefited from the Grih Jyoti Yojana. Emphasising the government’s approach, he said development and welfare were being pursued simultaneously. Reddy claimed that Telangana, once plagued by corruption, had been transformed into an economically strong State, with major industries set up and financial discipline maintained without increasing taxes. “If this can be achieved in Telangana, why not in Kerala?” he asked.



Welfare and development measures dominate manifestos of LDF, UDF

Vinson Kurian
Thiruvananthapuram

The ruling Left Democratic Front (LDF) and the Opposition United Democratic Front (UDF) released their manifestos at separate functions held in Kochi and Kozhikode on Thursday.

Both appeared to push pet themes of welfare and development ahead of polling next Thursday. The National Development Alliance (NDA) released its manifesto a day earlier.

LDF MANIFESTO

Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan released the LDF manifesto. It outlines a 60-point programme containing 950 proposals to create a *Nava Kerala* (New Kerala) even as it sought a mandate to continue ongoing development works.

The document includes a promise to eradicate absolute poverty, launch of Life Mission 2.0 to make Kerala “a no-homeless State”, hike

in welfare pension from ₹2,000 to ₹3,000, transformation of the State into a knowledge society in five years, assured job opportunities for educated youth through campus placements, a ‘Back to Campus’ scheme for skill enhancement, and interest-free loans for entrepreneurs.

The LDF promised to implement a universal health coverage scheme with limitless treatment benefits. All bed-ridden patients will get special treatment and schemes will be launched for senior citizens. The LDF proposed setting up, with public participation, a medico-research hospital in place of AIIMS, repeated requests for which have been spurned by the Centre.

UDF MANIFESTO

The UDF manifesto placed a strong emphasis on welfare guarantees, including free travel for women in KSRTC buses; ₹1,000 monthly financial assistance for college-

going girls; and an increase in welfare pensions to ₹3,000 per month.

The Leader of the Opposition, VD Satheesan, handed over a copy of the document to Telangana Chief Minister Revanth Reddy at a function in Kochi. It proposes a ‘Job Watch Tower’ to track changes in the job market and recommend curriculum reforms in higher education based on expert inputs.

HEALTH SCHEME

It proposes a free ‘Oommen Chandy Health Insurance’ coverage of up to ₹25 lakh for all families, interest-free loans up to ₹5 lakh for youth entrepreneurs, a dedicated department for senior citizens, and a procurement price of ₹35 per kg for paddy.

The manifesto promised a separate agriculture budget and measures to raise the support price of natural rubber to ₹300 per kg. To mitigate human-wildlife conflict, it suggested deploying advanced technologies such as

drones, artificial intelligence, and IoT-based monitoring systems to provide timely alerts on wildlife movement.

G Gopakumar, senior political scientist and former Vice-Chancellor of the Central University of Kerala, observed that the brief window afforded little scope for meaningful deliberation. The processes of interest articulation and aggregation were in all likelihood sidelined, leaving popular demands and aspirations inadequately reflected in the document.

Ideally, the document ought to have been released at least a month earlier, allowing for wider consultation and the meaningful participation of all stakeholders in shaping its policy contours.

As matters stand, all three fronts appear to have made an array of promises without clearly indicating the resources required for their fulfilment.

Halwa, coffee – Kerala’s sweet poll incentives for a high voter turnout

Chitra Narayanan
New Delhi

First-time voters in Kerala will be treated to Kozhikode halwa, thanks to a start-up called Fulva and the Election Department of Kerala, while Uber has been roped in to give free rides to voters up to their polling booths in select cities.

The Chief Electoral Officer’s office is also sewing up deals with retail brands to get fun deals for voters; for instance, free coffee from chains such as Starbucks if they show the ink on their fingers, discounts from SupplyCo and so on. A rap-based peppy youth anthem and fun competitions are part of a big drive to attract young voters.

After the SIR exercise, there are now 2.71 crore voters in Kerala. Of these, 4.6 lakh are first-time voters, while there are about 50 lakh voters aged between 18 and 30. In the last Assembly elections, the voter turnout dipped to a dismal 74 per cent. “This time, the CEC



GET INKED. Over the last few weeks, the election department has been engaged in a series of activities to get rid of voter apathy

has set us a target of 85 per cent for the State, but we want to outdo that by getting over 90 per cent turnout, if not 100,” declares Rathan U Kelkar, Chief Electoral Officer, Kerala.

COUNTING EVERYONE

Over the last few weeks, the Election Department has been engaged in a series of activities to get rid of voter apathy.

From sand art on beaches and installations in public spaces on themes of democracy to virtual reality shows, walkathons, lively debates



with recommendations on what actions should be taken to increase awareness among voters. “We have created a month-long Systematic Voter’s Education and Electoral Participation plan based on an analysis of where the voting percentage is less, and

which segment of people are not coming forward,” says Kelkar. For example, if women in a certain place do not come forward to vote, the department has organised cooking competitions and other activities to engage with them. To engage the

youth, activities such as beach cleaning for democracy were undertaken.

“We are not just carpet bombing with advertisements; instead, we are looking at particular segments and taking a particular approach to attract them,” says Kelkar, describing how houseboat competitions were held in Alappuzha.

REACHING TRIBALS

Kelkar says banks and companies are also supporting the democratic exercise through their CSR campaigns. For its part, the election unit, through BLOs, is trying to reach everyone in the State, including tribal communities in remote areas. To ensure that the 2.25 lakh people involved in the polling machinery — 1.75 lakh polling personnel, 5,000-odd police force and a significant number of emergency service providers are able to cast their votes — they are being given a postal ballot. “Every vote counts. No voter is left behind. That is our motto,” says Kelkar.

Rising crude prices push up cost of campaign materials

Kolkata: Rising crude prices amid the West Asia crisis are driving up costs of flex banners and other election campaign materials in poll-bound West Bengal, industry sources said. Printers and representatives of the plastic industry said packaging and flex printing costs had risen by around 15-20 per cent in recent weeks as petrochemical feedstock prices moved up following supply disruptions linked to the West Asia situation. Since plastic granules used in the manufacture of flex banners are derived from crude oil, fluctuations in crude prices have a direct bearing on the production cost of campaign materials widely used during elections, printing industry representatives said.

KK Seksaria, former President of the Plastindia Foundation, said raw material prices in the plastics value chain had surged sharply due to global supply disruptions. “There is a huge impact,” said Seksaria. Printers engaged in producing campaign banners said the rise in input costs had translated into higher printing charges. Traders in Burrabazar, one of the largest wholesale hubs for election merchandise, said demand for campaign materials such as flags, banners and scarves had started picking up as candidates begin filing nominations.

QUICKLY.

ICF rolls out a record 3,405 coaches in FY26



Chennai: Integral Coach Factory (ICF), the premier passenger coach manufacturing unit of Indian Railways, has surpassed its previous production records during the FY26. It rolled out 3,405 coaches, marking a 13 per cent increase from 3,007 produced the previous year, as per a release. **OUR BUREAU**

Alkem to increase funding to ₹1,036 cr for Ujjain unit

New Delhi: Alkem Laboratories Ltd announced almost doubling of investment to up to ₹1,036 crore for its proposed greenfield formulations manufacturing facility in Ujjain. The board of directors on April 2 has approved an increase in investment from ₹533 crore to up to ₹1,036 crore, the firm said in a regulatory filing. **PI**

RBI allows rupee exchange at airport departures



Mumbai: The RBI on Thursday allowed residents as well as non-residents to exchange rupee notes at foreign exchange counters at departure halls in international airports beyond the immigration or customs desk. Earlier, such foreign exchange counters were only allowed to buy rupee from non-residents and sell foreign currency to them. **PI**

Banks to face margin pressure: Fitch

PROFIT CRUSHED. Margins may fall 20–30 bps below its current 3.1% forecast for FY27 due to RBI liquidity limits

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Margin pressure on Indian banks could increase as the Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) flexibility to inject local-currency liquidity into the banking system has narrowed amid efforts to contain rupee volatility, cautioned Fitch Ratings. However, the credit rating agency believes banks' direct foreign-currency risks remain limited.

The agency assessed that sector margins could decline by 20-30 basis points (bps) below its current 3.1 per cent forecast for FY27, if higher funding costs linked to West Asia tensions persist. This could reduce operating profit/risk-weighted assets (RWAs) — Fitch Ratings' core earnings metric — by around 30-40 bps, from the earlier 2.5 per cent forecast.

Treasury gains could also be moderately below its previous expectations. But the agency believes that Fitch-rated banks have sufficient earnings buffers to absorb such pressure without affecting its assessment of their



DIP EXPECTED. Treasury gains could also be moderately below its previous expectations

earnings and profitability.

Fitch Ratings' base case assumed deposit costs would decline in FY27 as accommodative liquidity would enable further transmission of the RBI's 125 bps of policy rate cuts since December 2024; only 44 bps has been passed through to deposit rates as of January 2026, due to intensified competition for deposits with loan growth exceeding deposit growth.

"In response, the RBI increased the supply of durable liquidity to the banking system since second half (2HFY25) through government bond buybacks and open-market purchases. It also indicated that it would

remain proactive in maintaining adequate system liquidity," the agency said in a statement.

However, the banking-system liquidity surplus has declined to about 0.5 per cent of deposits as of 29 March 2026 — from 0.8 per cent in late February before the onset of the West Asia conflict — amid sustained currency pressures, with the rupee having depreciated by 4.5 per cent.

RUPEE VOLATILITY

If sustained, currency pressures could limit the RBI's ability to ease banking system liquidity, as measures to support the rupee also drain local-currency liquidity from

the banking system, cautioned the agency.

Fitch said rupee volatility is unlikely to have a material direct effect on Indian banks, as the system is denominated predominantly in local currency: overseas loans were under 10 per cent of sector loans, and the net open foreign-currency position was not significant at 2.5 per cent of equity at 9MFY25 (nine months).

The agency is not expecting currency weakness alone to affect asset quality significantly, as corporate borrowers typically hedge foreign-currency borrowings. Still, sustained currency weakness coupled with higher energy and raw material costs could raise inflation and weaken SME repayment capacity. Fitch observed that the RBI's recent directive for banks to unwind FX positions above \$100 million also highlights its focus on limiting currency volatility. However, the impact on banks' profit should be limited, as income from exchange transactions is estimated at less than about 0.1 per cent of RWAs.

The agency emphasised

that upside to Viability Ratings (VRs) remains if key rating drivers improve in line with its expectations, and the operating environment (OE) score is revised upward to 'bbb-'. This could occur if it assesses that the RBI remains committed to reforms implemented over the past decade, and that India's economic growth prospects remain intact.

Conversely, downside pressure could emerge if Fitch were to expect a significant and lasting adverse effect on India's economic growth from a prolonged conflict in the West Asia, for example through sustained pressure on energy prices and availability.

Fitch said Indian banks' Issuer Default Ratings (IDRs) would be likely to remain intact even in a downside scenario, as they are underpinned by sovereign support, and India's 'BBB-/Stable' sovereign rating has moderate headroom to absorb downside risks. However, Fitch's outlooks on the private banks' 'BB+/Positive' IDRs could be revised to stable if the OE outlook is revised to stable.

KK Singh takes additional charge as SAIL CMD

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Steel Authority of India Ltd (SAIL) on Thursday informed the stock exchanges that Krishna Kumar Singh has taken additional charge of Chairman & Managing Director of the company.

He succeeded Amarendu Prakash, who resigned on April 1.

Meanwhile, the company announced that it achieved its highest-ever performance in FY2025-26.

As per a stock exchange filing, Prakash submitted his resignation on January 2, 2026, to the Steel Ministry. It was approved with effect from April 1, 2026.

Accordingly, he handed over charge to Krishna Kumar Singh, Director (Personnel), SAIL. He has been given the additional charge of the post of CMD for a period of 3 months or till appointment and joining of regular incumbent to the post or until further orders, whichever is the earliest.

ANNUAL PERFORMANCE Meanwhile, in a statement, the company said it recorded



Krishna Kumar Singh, Director, SAIL

best-ever sales of 20.14 million tonnes (mt) in FY26, a growth of 11.5 per cent over the previous year's 18.07 mt.

The growth was broad-based, with sales rising across all product categories.

On the production front, the company delivered its best-ever crude steel output at 19.43 mt and saleable steel production at 19.176 mt, surpassing all previous records.

Achieving record supplies of 1.25 mt to the Indian Railways, alongside all-time high long rail production from the Universal Rail Mill, highlights operational excellence and strategic contribution to India's rail expansion.

Exports surged to 0.29 mt, registering a 162 per cent growth.

MFIs increasingly replacing high-cost informal lenders: MFIN report

Our Bureau
Mumbai

There is a structural transformation in India's credit landscape, with microfinance institutions increasingly replacing high-cost informal sources, according to a Micro Finance Industry Network (MFIN) report. Informal borrowing among microfinance customers declined from 46 per cent of all reported loans in 2011 to just 1 per cent in 2024-25.

Loans from regulated en-

tities (REs) are far more affordable, with a weighted average annual percentage rate (APR) of 27.3 per cent compared to a range of 97-178 per cent typically charged by informal lenders, per the report, which is based on a study conducted by the National Council of Applied Economic Research (NCAER).

The study indicates responsible borrowing behaviour, with an overall Fixed Obligation to Income Ratio (FOIR) of 18.7 per cent, which is well within the 50

per cent limit prescribed by the RBI.

MFIN said with an average monthly income of ₹25,844, borrowers allocate a significant share towards expenses, savings and repayments, suggesting the need for more granular household-level credit assessment.

The average loan size stands at ₹51,222 with an average tenure of 23 months, indicating short-to-medium-term credit cycles, with variations across States. About 75.4 per cent of the loans are utilised for business pur-

poses, while 78 per cent of borrowers contribute to household income and over half rely on income generated through loan-funded activities for repayment.

The report noted that encouraging trends are visible in financial behaviour, with 97.2 per cent of borrowers reporting regular savings, indicating the contribution of microfinance in ensuring that accounts do not turn dormant and 84.4 per cent reporting uptake of credit-linked insurance. Further, asset ownership patterns in-

dicate gradual economic progress, though ownership of high-value assets remains limited.

STRONG OUTREACH

The study highlighted strong outreach among underserved/ under penetrated population segments, with nearly 46 per cent of borrowers having low or no formal education. Borrowers are largely in the 26-45 age group and 76.1 per cent of households are nuclear.

Alok Misra, CEO & Director, MFIN, said the key

takeaway from the study is the clear shift towards formal credit, with a sharp decline in reliance on informal sources and improved borrower outcomes. At the same time, there is a need to further strengthen credit assessment, particularly around household cash flows, to mitigate risks of over-indebtedness.

"The positive trends in borrower engagement, savings behaviour and productive use of loans reinforce the sector's role in supporting livelihoods," he said.

V Anantha Nageswaran, Chief Economic Advisor, said MFIs today have a strong relationship of trust with millions of borrowers.

"This creates an opportunity to go beyond credit by strengthening financial literacy, improving awareness and supporting income enhancement through skilling and other interventions. Leveraging this engagement effectively can play an important role in advancing sustainable livelihoods and improving household resilience," he said.

IRDAI names LIC, New India, GIC as systemically important insurers for FY26

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

The Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI) has designated Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC), New India Assurance Company Ltd, and General Insurance Corporation of India as Domestic Systemically Important Insurers (D-SIIs) for FY26.

The list of D-SIIs remains unchanged from the previous fiscal.

D-SIIs refer to insurers of such size, market importance, and domestic as well as global interconnectedness that their distress or failure could cause significant dislocation in the domestic financial system. Therefore, the continued functioning of these insurers is critical for the uninterrupted availabil-

ity of insurance services to the national economy.

Given the nature of their operations and systemic importance, these insurers are required to continue strengthening corporate governance standards, identifying all relevant risks, and promoting a robust risk management framework and culture.

The move comes amid broader regulatory efforts to strengthen oversight in the insurance sector.

'DARK PATTERNS'

Separately, IRDAI asked entities offering insurance products on e-platforms to carry out a self-assessment of their compliance with the Guidelines on Prevention and Regulation of Dark Patterns issued by the Central Consumer Protection Authority (CCPA).

A report on compliance

status must be submitted to the Authority within 15 days, according to a circular.

Dark patterns refer to user interface designs that mislead or manipulate consumers into taking unintended actions.

The insurance regulator recently underscored the need for regulated entities offering insurance products on e-platforms to comply with the CCPA guidelines issued on November 30, 2023.

The move is in line with a broader regulatory push across the financial sector to curb deceptive digital practices. The Reserve Bank of India has also flagged concerns about "dark patterns".

The Authority has also constituted a joint expert group to implement the Ind AS framework, which is to be adopted by insurers for accounting purposes from April 1, 2026.

Emirates NBD gets RBI's approval to acquire up to 74% stake in RBL Bank

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Emirates NBD (P.J.S.C) has received the Reserve Bank of India's approval to acquire an aggregate of up to 74 per cent of the paid-up share capital of RBL Bank.

As per RBI approval, which is valid for one year with effect from April 1, the investor (ENBD) shall acquire and maintain a shareholding of at least 51 per cent of the paid-up share capital of RBL Bank.

The bank shall be classified as a foreign bank in subsidiary mode, with the investor as its parent foreign bank.

The provisions applicable to foreign banks operating in wholly owned subsidiary mode shall be applicable to the bank, except the require-



NEW FACE. RBL Bank shall be classified as a foreign bank in subsidiary mode, with the ENBD as its parent foreign bank

ment to have at least half of the directors attending board meetings to be independent directors shall not apply, per the approval details shared by RBL Bank in a regulatory filing.

VOTING RIGHTS

Further, RBL Bank has been advised to suitably amend its Articles of Association and obtain approval of the

bank," per the approval.

The voting rights of ENBD shall be capped at 26 per cent of the total voting rights of RBL, in accordance with the Banking Regulation Act, 1949.

ENBD has been exempted from the requirement of single mode of presence until its Indian branches are amalgamated with RBL Bank, or within one year, whichever is earlier.

In October 2025, RBL Bank announced that its board of directors had approved an investment of up to about \$3 billion by ENBD through a preferential issue to acquire a 60 per cent controlling stake in the bank.

This also triggers a mandatory open offer to be made by ENBD for the purchase of a stake of up to 26 per cent from the public shareholders of RBL Bank.

IT is no longer the job hub of India but aspirations remain, says Xpheno chief

bl.interview

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

Since the Covid-19 era, IT industry hiring has dipped from around 6 lakh hires to a little over 1 lakh freshers per year. While these numbers are not expected to worsen, trends in India's hiring ecosystem indicate a talent friction, hinting that the idea of the IT sector as a haven for fresher hiring may finally have passed. Kamal Karanth, Co-Founder of Xpheno, a specialist staffing firm, talks about what skill-sets the IT sector, specifically the GCC segment, still looks for and how hires can navigate these waters.

Edited excerpts:

Has the hiring pattern of IT firms changed? The percentage of fresher hiring has come down be-

cause of lack of demand. Last year GCCs hired about 1.20 lakh freshers, with 50 per cent coming from IT services companies. We expect this year's numbers to be the same. As long as IT services companies' headcount does not grow, fresher hiring takes a beating. However, there has been net growth among GCCs and consulting companies. Tech giants added 31,000 jobs last year. So each cohort is different. Around 58,000 techies also went outside India last year, although almost 30,000 of them have come back. So, there is a talent friction.

How are GCCs behaving in terms of hiring?

GCCs have hired more in the last 12 months, driven by the growth of 145 Greenfield GCCs in the past 13 months. Of these, 85 GCCs came just last year and maximum hiring happens in the first two years. It is estimated that

Mass hiring has structurally changed to a niche hiring context in India now... There will be more of a 'try-before-you-hire' model where firms hire people on an interim basis and then convert them to full-time roles

KAMAL KARANATH
Co-Founder of Xpheno

about 100 Greenfield GCCs will come to India this year. There is also marginal movement happening in the large GCCs that are already in India. Some of them are seeing growth of 5-6 per cent.

What kind of skill sets do GCCs look for?

Data science is one skill set which is in demand for



GCCs, followed by cybersecurity and then cloud. They pay about 20 per cent higher than IT services companies.

What level of expertise do these companies [GCCs and IT service firms] look for during hiring?

Domain and technology become two very important as-

pects when it comes to hiring. But, GCCs prefer those working for a fellow GCC because they know what it takes to work in a GCC.

Hiring is changing from a pyramid shape. Have you seen any particular leaning by companies?

Definitely, we have seen the pyramid shape becoming a diamond shape but cylindrical is the way to go. Firms will need people who can talk and lead, and people who are doers at the bottom. So the middle level, who used to be pure people managers, are being carefully looked at. There are 3-4 kinds of people in an organisation at the middle level with technological, domain and client understanding. The pure people managers are the ones in danger.

Going forward, how do you see the hiring trend progressing in India?

Mass hiring has structurally changed to a niche hiring context in India now. Earlier, everything was about numbers and in India, we like scale. So there will be more of a 'try-before-you-hire' model where firms hire people on an interim basis and then convert them to full-time roles.

Is the IT sector done and dusted with its mass hiring phase?

It is, but people have not given up. They think it is a passing cloud. Every day the situation changes. The number of open jobs in software in the last month is one of the highest in the US. It is not easy for people to take engineering out of their DNA.

Are all these changes, trends and preferences a result of the AI age?

Definitely there is an anticipation that AI is better at least

in software development, application development and maintenance but not many proof of concepts have been developed. What it can do is being speculated upon; it has not really fully transformed the sector. The larger issue is low demand owing to war, tariffs and other things. But, the latest results will be interesting to see in April.

Why do you say the coming quarter is going to be interesting?

The maximum noise related to Anthropic and similar events has happened in this quarter. So it will be interesting to see how companies added people. They may say that they used AI and now our headcount is flat.

How would you advise freshers to go forward?

They have to look at jobs in non-software areas. People have to start working in allied areas.

LG India sells 1 m air-conditioners in March quarter

Our Bureau
New Delhi

LG Electronics India on Thursday said it sold over one million air-conditioners in the March quarter and that it reflects the strongest start to the summer season in the company's history.

It also said it is expanding its AC manufacturing facility at Sri City in Andhra Pradesh.

The company said it launched its new BEE star-rated compliant AC line-up well ahead of the season to support the transition of retail partners and consumers.

Hong Ju Jeon, Managing Director, LG Electronics India, said: "We are investing heavily in innovation, distribution, localisation, and are expanding our AC manufacturing facility in Sri City to reinforce our commitment to the 'Make in India' initiative."

Sanjay Chitkara, Director & Co-Chief Sales and Marketing Officer, LG Electronics India, added, "Building on this momentum, we are focused on delivering advanced, energy-efficient cooling solutions tailored for domestic and global consumers. We are highly motivated with our first quarter AC performance and anticipate a stronger demand in Q2CY 2026 aided by the GST cuts on ACs."

During the quarter, LG widened its AC line-up with new launches including 0.8 ton AC under its Essential Series and the 2 ton 5-star range that caters to the rapidly expanding premium home segment. This included introduction of a comprehensive fixed-speed AC portfolio to capture demand across every price tier and consumer profile.

The company added that GST reduction on air conditioners been a structural game-changer for the industry, improving affordability and accelerating democratisation of energy-efficient cooling across urban and semi-urban India.



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NOTICE

Notice is hereby given that the following locker hirers have availed locker facilities from our Bank.

They have failed /neglected in making payments towards the locker rentals to the Bank or not operated the locker for a considerable period. The Bank has issued several notices to the below-mentioned locker hirers requesting them to make payment towards locker rentals or operate the locker and/or close the locker facility(ies). The communication in this regard was either duly acknowledged by them and/or returned undelivered.

This is the final notice to notify that if the below-mentioned locker hirers fail to pay the arrears of locker rentals to the Bank or do not operate the locker on or before **02/07/2026**, the Bank shall break and open the locks of the locker and take inventory of any items lying in the locker. All such items will be kept in the Bank’s custody until such time the arrears of rent along with interest, expenses, charges, etc. are paid to the Bank. This will be done as per the Banking Law and Practice and at locker hirer’s risk and responsibility.

If any cash is found in the locker, the Bank reserves the right to adjust the same against the outstanding dues and it shall be treated as proper discharge on part of the Bank and no claims, whatsoever, shall be entertained thereafter in this regard. For the outstanding dues of locker rentals, the Bank reserves its right to proceed legally against the locker hirer(s) for recovery of its dues.

Sr No.	Locker no.	Name of the Locker Hirer(s)	Address	Amount due (INR)	Amount due from	Sr No.	Locker no.	Name of the Locker Hirer(s)	Address	Amount due (INR)	Amount due from						
Appakudal Branch: Door No. 2/2 & 3/3 No. 1012 Kavundapady Main Rd,Sakthi Nagar, Appakudal,Erode, Tamil Nadu,638315						Periasemur Branch: Annamalai Complex,Sathy Main Rd,Veerappanchathiram,Post Off Periyasemur,Erode,638004						Trichy Road Branch: Door No. 1216, Ts.No.1474 & 1475 Trichy Rd. Next to Bannari Amman Sugars Ltd Coimbatore 641018					
01	54	Rajakumar D	24Vandapalayam Main Road Kivindupadi Bhavani,Erode,Tamil Nadu,India,638455	14630	21-02-2019	80	44	Muthiyasam	22 Setthiyampalayam East Street Suriyampalayam Rd,Puduppost,Palayam,Rn, Pudurpost,Erode,Tamil Nadu,India,638004	13065.71	24-4-2025	147	186	J Jagathi	1473 Ward No 26 Trichy Road Trichy Road Near Richmond Hospital, Coimbatore,Tamil Nadu,India,641018	60603.95	21-06-2021
02	29	B Annadurai	6-120 Periya Thottam Chiravipudai Orcheri Bhavani,Erode,Tamil Nadu, India,638315	14045.71	23-04-2019	81	26	Gowindam	53H, Pon Complex Thottam Thottam, Sooki, Erode,Tamil Nadu,India,638004	64462.25	22-10-2021	148	243	S Shanugam	The Mothers Garden Visalakshi Colony Gokulam Colony Ext Koval Pudur , Coimbatore,Tamil Nadu,India,641042	210787.38	11-06-2020
03	74	Balasubramaniam S	No-532 Ettikudi Thottam Kumarapalayam Kuppandalapalayam Namakkal 638183,Namakkal,Tamil Nadu,India,638181	34801.89	28-01-2021	82	10	D Vijayarathnam	21/1, Mayyavanagar Koval Street, Pechapalli Medu, Erode, Veerappanchathiram (M), Erode,Tamil Nadu,India,638004	27637.5	03-06-2021	149	37	Raghunathan	72, Ramana Nagar, Uppilappalayam Coimbatore Southcoimbatore, Coimbatore,Tamil Nadu,India,641015	23422.35	03-06-2022
04	71	N Subathra	Sarathi College,Annamalai Appertment Shanthi Vinayagar Nagar Narasotkali Salem,Tamil Nadu,India,636004	18812.5	15-05-2019	83	74	Baheer Ahmedkhan	20 Wadi Street Aul Vidiyan Nagar Sooki, Erode,Tamil Nadu,India,638004	27637.5	03-06-2021	150	197	M Manikandan	39 Gopal Pillai Street Sular Palladam Tk, Coimbatore,Tamil Nadu,India,641402	44523.53	18-10-2024
Attur Branch: 910, Nireesh Complex,Cuddalore Main Road,Attur 636102, Dist. Salem, Tamil Nadu						Pollachi Branch: 132/1,BSNL Building,G Floor,Opposite New Bus Std,Palakkad Rd., Pollachi,Coimbatore,Tamil Nadu 642001						Saibaba Colony, Coimbatore Branch: No.56 Bharathi Park, 2nd Cross Rd, Saibaba Colony,Coimbatore, Tamil Nadu, 641011					
05	24	Shedra M	No-4/27A, Kothambakk, Kallaganur (Po) Attur (Tk) Salem (Dt) Attur (Tk), Tamil Nadu,India,636109	12792.5	29-11-2019	84	37	K K Manickam	Old No 29A New No 42 Agalappa Layout, Pollachi,Tamil Nadu,India,642001	19287.45	26-12-2019	151	107	Madhuchamy M	No-4C, Orange Enclave, Shrinaga Theer Street, Coimbatore,Tamil Nadu,India,641045	4573.127	07-07-2021
06	105	A B Rajamahendran	Old 10 New 31 V O C Nagar Attur Tk., Salem,Tamil Nadu,India,636102	11596.02	24-04-2023	85	14	K Ganesh Kumar	2135-Ranga Sanathiram Zamin Kottampatti Subeswaraswathi Pollachi,Pollachi, Tamil Nadu,India,642006	12792.5	23-04-2019	152	113	Gowden Kall	84, Nataraj Layout, Sivaram Nagar, Ramanaathapuram, Coimbatore-45 Coimbatore,Tamil Nadu,India,641045	51433.47	03-06-2022
07	2	Sudha Mahendran	302/33 Kallisanthar Koval Street Attur,Salem,Tamil Nadu,India,636102	5952.5	21-01-2020	86	56	Chandramohan A C	21/1, Mayyavanagar Koval Street, Pechapalli Medu, Erode, Veerappanchathiram (M), Erode,Tamil Nadu,India,638004	22077.51	13-12-2018	153	39	R Regis	Periya Vinayagar Nagar,Plot No 10 Kallappatti,Coimbatore,Tamil Nadu,India,641048	19706.13	22-02-2023
08	8	Jayaseetha A	No-52/K Narayanasamy Nagar Attur Tk,Attur,Salem,Tamil Nadu,India,636102	12792.5	23-04-2019	87	34	Sapathaly V	72E Thottahalli Sali Thigalpalayam Thalakkarai, Pollachi,Tamil Nadu,India,642005	14621.31	08-01-2019	154	1	R Vijayaraghathan	42/2 Annamalai Finance 54/2 Annamalai Finance Complex, Singapore, Coimbatore,Tamil Nadu,India,641005	97408.75	06-03-2020
09	59	R Dhankalshmi	No-42 Karikalam Street Attur, Salem,Tamil Nadu,India,636102	8862.07	03-06-2021	88	164	Muthukumar R	1-166/119 Vinayakar Koval Street Nallathukudi Pollachi, Coimbatore,Tamil Nadu, India,642005	8437.5	20-09-2022	155	104	Daisy Andrayayagam	Coimbatore Near Red Fields Road,Coimbatore,Tamil Nadu,India,641045	34708.75	06-03-2020
Avanashi Branch: Sri Saibaba Tower, No.326, Post office street Main road, Avanashi 641654						89	66	Anantham Muthusamy	160A One Street Adavayakulam Po Pollachi Coimbatore Rural, Pollachi,Tamil Nadu, India,642129	0	24-04-2025	156	55	Pichai Veerasenan	Coimbatore Near Red Fields Road,Coimbatore,Tamil Nadu,India,641045	34193.08	23-4-2019
10	4	Eswaran M	1/339 Semimala Goundan Puttur Sembiyanallur Veluthamalaiyagam, Tiruppur,Tamil Nadu,India,641654	18812.5	19-06-2019	90	159	R K Mathan	133 Ringar V K Vayal Pollachi, Pollachi,Tamil Nadu,India,642001	27636.38	07-07-2021	Vazhapadi Branch: No.224/12, Cuddalore Main Road, Vazhapadi, Dist. Salem, Tamil Nadu, Pin 636115					
Cherry Road Branch: NM Arcade, No.252, Meyyanur Bypass Road, Meyyanur, Salem 636 004, Salem Dist						91	95	P K Duraisami	133 Ringar V K Vayal Pollachi, Pollachi,Tamil Nadu,India,642001	8542.5	07-07-2021	157	49	Dhineshkumar S	D No 13/21B Ayothiyathangam Main Road Balur Po Vakapady Tk, Salem, Tamil Nadu,India,636104	12792.5	10-06-2019
11	60	Dileep Dinkaralan	23/22 West Vinayakar Koval Street Hastham Pattu,Salem,Tamil Nadu,India,636007	22502.87	07-07-2021	92	151	Nayanaethan A	Bharthy Nagar Sangam Palayam Achappatti Coimbatore,Coimbatore,Tamil Nadu, India,642002	120175.34	25-4-2020	158	5	Gowthaman	O No 580 N No-3/201 Thimbal Attur Tk., Salem,Tamil Nadu,India,636114	10790.1	11-06-2020
12	19	Ganeshkumar Gunasekaran	Plot 108 Santyapana Nagar 39d Cross West Seelankal Enpatti Dasinayakanpatti, Salem,Tamil Nadu,India,636201	36813.5	13-12-2018	93	127	Prabhu M	Saranampattay Main Roadnear To Don Bosco SchoolKallinar Pir Iruvelkallinar, Coimbatore,Tamil Nadu,India,641029	0	24-4-2025	159	11	Arun Prakash	S/O Thangaraj 516 Ananda Nagar Sekkidiappatti Sekkidiappatti Po Sekkidiappatti Near Bus Stop, Salem,Tamil Nadu,India,636104	10695.13	28-01-2021
13	95	Muthumalai Valeran	26/54 K Krishnamani Nagar Opp Sarathi College Road Salem Fairlands Near By Sarathi College,Salem,Tamil Nadu,India,636012	42322.5	11-06-2020	94	130	Ramamurthy D	100 B Bharathi Colony Pekkadam Coimbatore South,Coimbatore,Tamil Nadu, India,641004	0	23-04-2025	160	24	G Prakasham	21/19 Naidu Street Thanduran Po Attur Tk,Salem Dt,Salem,Tamil Nadu, India,636117	10702.56	05-02-2021
Coimbatore Branch: No.1133, 1135 & 1136, Avinashi Road, Pappannaikal Palayam, Coimbatore, Tamil Nadu, Pin 641 037						95	130	Ramamurthy D	100 B Bharathi Colony Pekkadam Coimbatore South,Coimbatore,Tamil Nadu, India,641004	0	23-04-2025	Saibaba Colony, Coimbatore Branch: No.56 Bharathi Park, 2nd Cross Rd, Saibaba Colony,Coimbatore, Tamil Nadu, 641011					
14	213	Thirumorthy Padmanaban	Information Evolution India Pvt Ltd 138 G Grays Hill Sims Park Conoor, Coonoor, Tamil Nadu,India,643101	26690.25	18-09-2019	96	10	Chitra Ramamurthy	108 B The Near Bharathi Colony Pekkadam Coimbatore,Tamil Nadu,India,641004	59021.48	23-12-2021	161	1009	Manoj Kumar S	No 126/12 Lakshmi Endave Phase 2 Velakinar Pirivu G N Mill Post, Coimbatore, Tamil Nadu,India,641029	0	24-04-2025
15	129	Sethin Thomas	1 Veluthangam Nagar Saranathapuram Saravanampatti Coimbatore North Saranganampatti, Coimbatore,Tamil Nadu,India,641035	101410.45	07-07-2021	97	8	Deepa Sathishkumar	27/43 Maraiman Temple Street Veerakeralam Coimbatore Coimbatore North S.B. Institute,Coimbatore,Tamil Nadu,India,641007	0	24-04-2025	162	8362	Anburaja K	159/230 Ron Layout Venkataswamy Road New Siddapudur Opp Arcoya Bakery, Coimbatore,Tamil Nadu,India,641044	24022.65	24-06-2021
16	157	Kajinimohammed M	25/5 Nadai Nagar Saranathapuram Saravanampatti Coimbatore, Tamil Nadu,India,641001	83522.3	23-04-2019	98	77	Sanjeevkumar	D No 2/05 Thirunangalam Thirunangalam Post, Thiruchengode Taluk, Namakkal Dist., Salem,Tamil Nadu,India,637211	0	24-04-2025	163	8318	Ravichandran N	18/14 Marudamalai Street Kallinar Pir Iruvelkallinar, Coimbatore,Tamil Nadu,India,641044	32685.25	13-11-2018
17	418	P N Lashman	10/19 The Estate Road Tea Esta Race Course,Coimbatore,Tamil Nadu,India,641035	28397.75	23-04-2019	99	126	Menakshisundaram	167 Naniappanappalayam Kothamangalam Paramathivudai,Kothamangalam, Tamil Nadu,India,637211	104970.85	26-10-2020	164	8362	Ravichandran N	18/14 Marudamalai Street Kallinar Pir Iruvelkallinar, Coimbatore,Tamil Nadu,India,641044	32685.25	13-11-2018
18	191	P Ganeshram	No 2/2 Padinayala Layout Velikur Road Podanur, Coimbatore,Tamil Nadu, India,641023	63483.75	11-06-2020	100	129	Shanmuga Nathan S	202 2Nd Floor 30 Racecourse Road Coimbatore South,Coimbatore,Tamil Nadu, India,641018	120175.34	11-02-2019	165	2016	Subbiah M	18/14 Marudamalai Street Kallinar Pir Iruvelkallinar, Coimbatore,Tamil Nadu,India,641044	28937.75	23-04-2019
19	94	P N Lashman	7/5 And Nagar Coimbatore South Po Uppilappalayam Dist, Coimbatore, Tamil Nadu,India,641015	58202.39	24-04-2024	101	67	T R C Muralidharan	202 2Nd Floor 30 Racecourse Road Coimbatore South,Coimbatore,Tamil Nadu, India,641018	120969.15	23-04-2019	166	1016	Amuthakall	H28,Green Hill Apartment Trishy Colony Tambaram Sanatorium,Chennai, Tamil Nadu,India,600047	58622.03	26-09-2019
20	96	N Valsikhanvi Priya	No 10/25A Kallappalayam Road Coimbatore South Coimbatore Annamalai Road,Coimbatore,Tamil Nadu,India,641015	0	24-04-2025	102	9	N Srividhya	202 2Nd Floor 30 Racecourse Road Coimbatore South,Coimbatore,Tamil Nadu, India,641018	0	24-04-2025	167	2074	Ram Siv Prakash	Coimbatore,Tamil Nadu,India,641027	153828.01	08-01-2019
21	249	Vidhya Sai	13/19 The Estate Road Tea Esta Race Course,Coimbatore,Tamil Nadu,India,641018	0	24-04-2025	103	8024	T Kanagapathi	208 Salem Road Tiruchengudi,Tamil Nadu,India,637211	12792.5	29-11-2019	168	8339	Pragadee Krishnan	Old No 312 New No 179 Thadaganai Link Road, Coimbatore,Tamil Nadu, India,641013	0	24-04-2025
22	141	C Soundararajan	26/54 K Krishnamani Nagar Opp Sarathi College Road Salem Fairlands Near By Sarathi College,Salem,Tamil Nadu,India,636012	94544.85	06-03-2020	104	9020	Dhanakodi P	No 2/05 Thirunangalam Thirunangalam Post, Thiruchengode Taluk, Namakkal Dist., Salem,Tamil Nadu,India,637211	15750	11-06-2020	169	6028	Ramachandramoorthy R	No 11 Nagalingam Street, Salem,Tamil Nadu,India,636007	97261.96	24-04-2024
23	34	N Kandasamy	No 10/25A Kallappalayam Road Coimbatore South Coimbatore Annamalai Road,Coimbatore,Tamil Nadu,India,641015	28397.75	13-05-2019	105	9007	Mahibalan A	No 4/04 Kallappalayam Road Tiruchengudi,Tamil Nadu,India,637211	0	24-04-2025	170	1023	Sahayabany H	Salern,Tamil Nadu,India,636008	34340.83	05-08-2021
24	403	Veer Lab Products Private Limited	Unit No 10 Ground Floor Empire Refractory Building Plot No 29 Old Plot No 10 Private Limited, Tamil Nadu,India,640012	0	24-04-2025	106	6040	P Lakshmanan	167 Naniappanappalayam Kothamangalam Paramathivudai,Kothamangalam, Tamil Nadu,India,637211	15750	11-06-2020	171	8334	Saral P	No 10/25A Kallappalayam Road Tiruchengudi,Tamil Nadu,India,637211	0	24-04-2025
Dharampur Branch: 51, New Housing Unit, Near new bus stand, Dharampur, Dist. Tirupur, Tamil Nadu, Pin 638656						107	6032	Padmajayothi Kannan	167 Naniappanappalayam Kothamangalam Paramathivudai,Kothamangalam, Tamil Nadu,India,637211	15750	11-06-2020	172	3003	Sidhar Suryakumar	No 2/05 Thirunangalam Thirunangalam Post, Thiruchengode Taluk, Namakkal Dist., Salem,Tamil Nadu,India,637211	97534.33	15-05-2019
25	70	R Kalavathi	33A/22Thiruvalluvar Veedhi, Chinnakkam Patti, Velluvai Puttur Post, Dharampur, Tirupur, Kottimayil, Erode,Tamil Nadu,India,638657	26031.7	22-05-2024	108	8068	V Karthi	8/22 A First Street Kamathenu Nagar Mettasuvampalayam Bhavani Erode, Tamil Nadu,India,638716	25439.75	13-12-2018	Salem Branch: 41/2, First & Second Floor, Ramakrishna Road, Salem, Tamil Nadu, Pin 636007					
26	45	Subramanian Palanisamy	No 10/25A Kallappalayam Road Tiruchengudi,Tamil Nadu,India,637211	8542.5	03-06-2021	109	5012	Badrinath Ganesan	8/22 A First Street Kamathenu Nagar Mettasuvampalayam Bhavani Erode, Tamil Nadu,India,638716	170236.65	13-12-2018	173	283	Vaidheki S	No11 Nagalingam Street, Salem,Tamil Nadu,India,636007	32685.25	07-01-2019
27	71	Nandhan	21/1, Chennai Kallappalayam Dharampur Dakshinapattinam Near Vinayagar S/O Thirunangalam, No 21, Rajagounder Avenue Coimbatore North,Teachers 28 Narayana Street,Chennai P Dharampur Tk Narayanaapuram,Erode, Tamil Nadu,India,638657	15750.06	29-03-2021	110	9011	S Sivaswamee	8/22 A First Street Kamathenu Nagar Mettasuvampalayam Bhavani Erode, Tamil Nadu,India,638716	18812.5	15-05-2019	174	54	G Karthikeyan	C/O Ganesan 323 Omkar Main Road Near New Bus Stand High Bazaar , Salem,Tamil Nadu,India,636008	25956.5	23-05-2020
28	69	N Sampathkumar	28 Narayana Street,Chennai P Dharampur Tk Narayanaapuram,Erode, Tamil Nadu,India,638657	18506.25	13-12-2019	111	9046	M Mahanraj	8/22 A First Street Kamathenu Nagar Mettasuvampalayam Bhavani Erode, Tamil Nadu,India,638716	18812.5	15-05-2019	175	38	Subramanian	No 1/25A Kallappalayam Road Tiruchengudi,Tamil Nadu,India,637211	66817.63	19-02-2021
Dharmapuri Branch: Door No. 171A (T S No. 80/1), Nethaji Bye Pass Road, Dharmapuri, Tamil Nadu, 636701						112	8030	Soundararajan N	8/22 A First Street Kamathenu Nagar Mettasuvampalayam Bhavani Erode, Tamil Nadu,India,638716	2082.5	22-05-2024	176	134	Ganesh Kumar N	Salern,Tamil Nadu,India,636007	10837.25	06-05-2020
29	136	Krishnan Allimuthu	D No 7/58 Kodiyar A Jetthilal Adiyamankottai Dharmapuri Kottiyar Dharmapuri, Tamil Nadu,India,636827	17750	09-10-2019	113	5012	Badrinath Ganesan	8/22 A First Street Kamathenu Nagar Mettasuvampalayam Bhavani Erode, Tamil Nadu,India,638716	170236.65	13-12-2018	177	22	N Padmanaban	13 No 29 Bhagav Street No 1 Resouram (T Namakkal Dt,Resouram,Tamil Nadu, India,637042	28397.75	27-12-2019
30	10	Kathiresan	No 40 Duraisami Street , Dharmapuri,Tamil Nadu,India,636701	18506.25	23-04-2019	114	4004	Anandranjan A	8/22 A First Street Kamathenu Nagar Mettasuvampalayam Bhavani Erode, Tamil Nadu,India,638716	18812.5	15-05-2019	178	144	Subashini S	180 Arts Park View Apartments Tambikangam Main Road ,Salem,Tamil Nadu, India,636007	91933.75	20-08-2020
31	104	P Kalliyann	No 25A Kallappalayam Road Tiruchengudi,Tamil Nadu,India,63701	8542.5	03-06-2021	115	9043	M Mohanraj	8/22 A First Street Kamathenu Nagar Mettasuvampalayam Bhavani Erode, Tamil Nadu,India,638716	18812.5	15-05-2019	179	1	Venket Thirumalai	No 1/25A Kallappalayam Road Tiruchengudi,Tamil Nadu,India,63701	113104.65	06-05-2020
32	46	Nandhan	No 25A Kallappalayam Road Tiruchengudi,Tamil Nadu,India,63701	8542.5	03-06-2021	116	1070	R Lakshmanan	8/22 A First Street Kamathenu Nagar Mettasuvampalayam Bhavani Erode, Tamil Nadu,India,638716	18812.5	15-05-2019	180	71	G Vedhamoorthy	28/4/20 Varma Garden Chinnai Kallipatti Kannankuruchi Mob No Net Ctr, Salem,Tamil Nadu,India,636008	0	24-06-2025
Edanganasalai Branch: Thirukumanar Towers, Kallappalayam Main Road, Edanganasalai Dist.Salem, Tamil Nadu, Pin 637508						117	5015	A Kallagan	8/22 A First Street Kamathenu Nagar Mettasuvampalayam Bhavani Erode, Tamil Nadu,India,638716	25439.75	13-12-2018	181	48	Sekakumar S	No 1/25A Kallappalayam Road Tiruchengudi,Tamil Nadu,India,637211	113104.65	06-05-2020
33	1	Rajendran S	1-7-4, Devarayan Nagar, R S P Mahal, Salem, Kuduam, Salem,Tamil Nadu, India,636701	8542.5	29-07-2021	118	4025	A Suresh	8/22 A First Street Kamathenu Nagar Mettasuvampalayam Bhavani Erode, Tamil Nadu,India,638716	18812.5	15-05-2019	182	132	R Pandima Devi	No 1/25A Kallappalayam Road Tiruchengudi,Tamil Nadu,India,63701	113104.65	06-05-2020
34	20	Sathishkumar Rajamani	D No 6/90 Reddipatti Perumangundappatti Kallappatti Po Kallappatti, Salem,Tamil Nadu,India,637504	0	23-05-2025	119	4026	G Govindasamy	8/22 A First Street Kamathenu Nagar Mettasuvampalayam Bhavani Erode, Tamil Nadu,India,638716	18812.5	15-05-2019	183	347	Govind M	No 1/25A Kallappalayam Road Tiruchengudi,Tamil Nadu,India,63701	113104.65	06-05-2020
Edappadi Branch: Periyandavur Plaza, T S No. 2/4A,Salem main Road,Nainampatti,Edappadi Dist,Salem, Tamil Nadu, Pin 637508						120	4025	G Govindasamy	8/22 A First Street Kamathenu Nagar Mettasuvampalayam Bhavani Erode, Tamil Nadu,India,638716	18812.5	15-05-2019	184	1	Venket Thirumalai	No 1/25A Kallappalayam Road Tiruchengudi,Tamil Nadu,India,63701	113104.65	06-05-2020
35	30	A Jayakumar	1/1 K1 Kishikampalam Kall Vakkal Endavay, Salem,Tamil Nadu,India,6370														

Closing price is the average of trade price(s) for the last half an hour; 52-Week High/Low figures pertain to BSE.

Shares of face value other than ₹10 is indicated in brackets immediately following the name of the company.

(No of shares traded) is denoted in thousands.

PE (price-earnings multiple) of each stock is based on the latest declared earnings.

PC computation takes into account the per share earnings of each company for the latest 12 months.

Arunis Abd	96.24	101.05	Carlisle	1756.20	1690.55	Emudra [5]	392.35	411.00	Hemphr. Prop	119.45	117.95	Jio Fin	232.00	229.55	Macrotech De	685.25	696.35	Novartis [5]	1014.00	1027.75	Rajnish Wei [1]	0.44	0.45	Shringar House	178.25	176.05
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